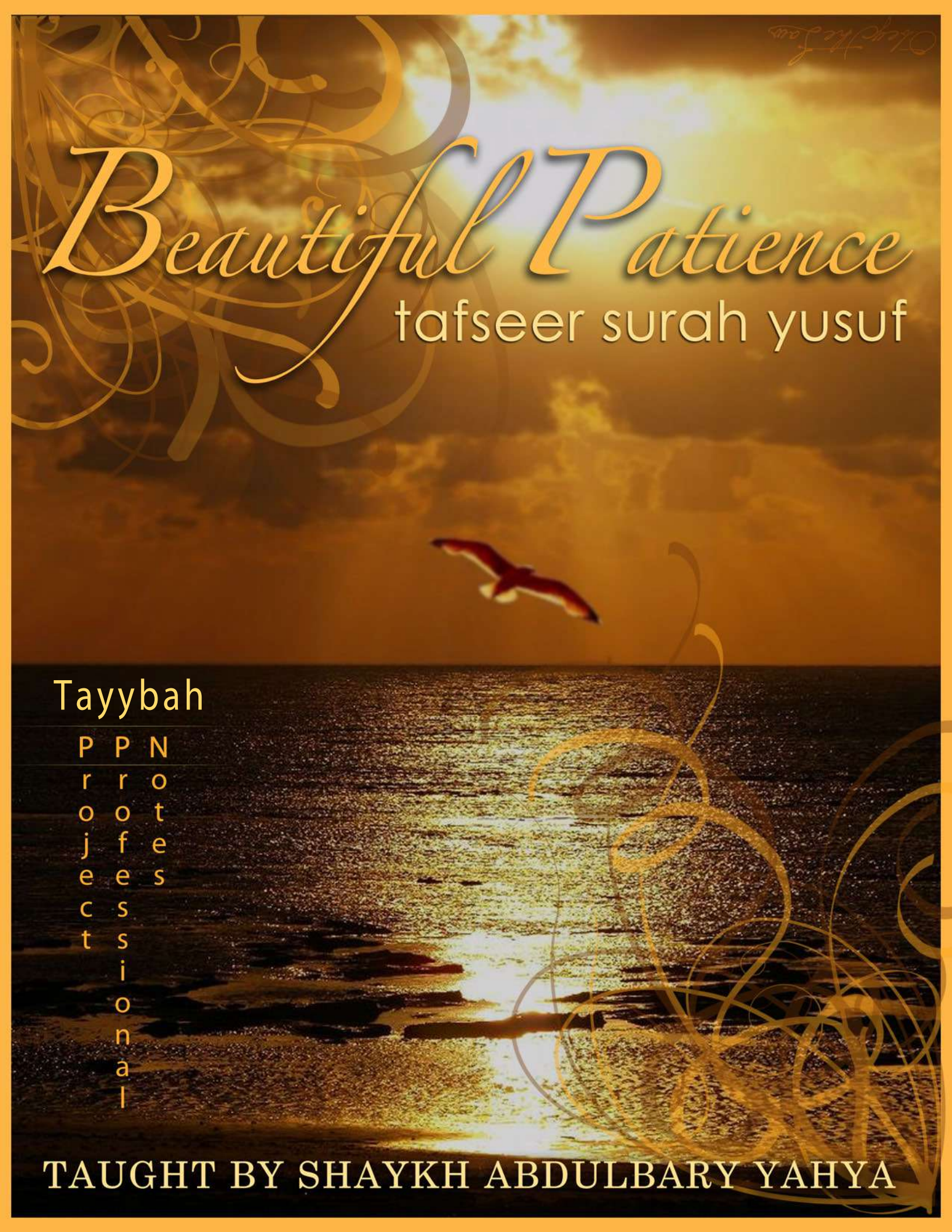




Shaykh Yahya

Beautiful Patience

tafseer surah yusuf

Tayybah

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TAUGHT BY SHAYKH ABDULBARY YAHYA

DEDICATION

To

“THE” Gluestick

بسم الله الرحمن الرحيم

Asalaamu Alaykum wa Rahmatullahi Wa Barakatuh

This PPN is dedicated to the founder and first member of PPN, Br Waleed Tawfik.

Recently Br. Waleed has been sick so we would like to dedicate this PPN which teaches us the importance of being patient in all cases and situations. May this project be a form of Sadaqah Jaariyah for you in the hereafter.

We Ask Allah Lord and Sustainer of mankind to remove his difficulty, pain, cure him, and forgive his sins. Oh Allah you are the only One who cures, there is no cure but yours. Grant such (complete) cure that leaves no trace of illness. May Allah grant you strength in your Deen and your health, Ameen.

"Patience is most fitting" and in the meantime

Your cup of tea is still standing by

-

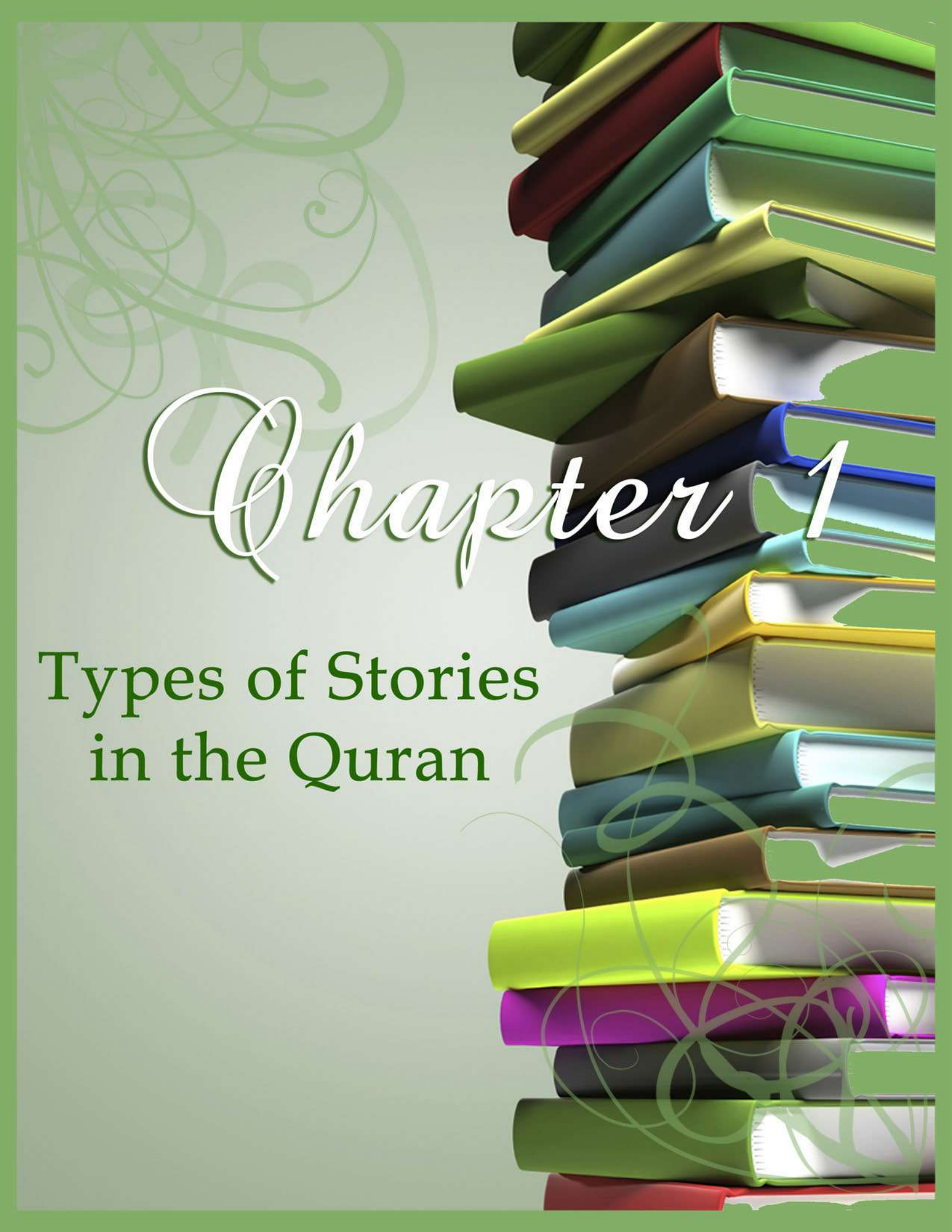
Your PPN Family and Zabeelat Tayybah

WORD OF CAUTION!

1. Project - Professional Notes (PPN) is a student-run initiative of the members of Qabeelat Tayybah, NY and is not sponsored or approved in anyway by AlMaghrib Institute or its employees.
2. Owing to the fact that PPN is a compilation of notes taken during the entire course of the Seminar for the members of Qabeelat Tayybah by its members, no statement or directive of any nature contained within has been approved by the Instructor teaching the Seminar.
3. The fact that PPN is a product of the note-taking abilities of the members of Qabeelat Tayybah is a testament to the fallible nature of its contents, i.e. its contents are not of an authoritative or binding nature. Moreover, PPN cannot be depended upon reliably as a source of legal Islamic injunctions or rulings.
4. There is nothing comparable to attending an AlMaghrib Seminar on one's own volition to fully appreciate the experience of learning from Instructors proficient in their field of instruction. It is, therefore, a sincere advice from the members of the PPN Crew to the bearers of these Notes that taking detailed notes on your own is the optimal way to prepare for the exam.
5. One of the goals of PPN is to serve as a contingency for where its bearers might have missed or overlooked some portion of their notes during the course of the Seminar. However, depending on these Notes alone to prepare for the exam will not suffice and is not recommended.
6. Another intended goal of PPN is to promote willingness in its bearers to fulfill their commitment to Qabeelat Tayybah and to AlMaghrib Institute – preparing for and appearing for the exam.
7. Thus far PPN has remained an unbiased, free enterprise and your charitable donations for need-based scholarships to Qabeelat Tayybah shall continue to maintain PPN as such.
8. Lastly the members of the PPN Crew would like to seize this opportunity to ask for your forgiveness, beforehand, for any slights or oversights on our behalf in the preparation of these Notes. We welcome your questions, critiques, comments and suggestions for the betterment of this ongoing charity at Tayybah.professionalnotes@gmail.com

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Chapter 1

Types of Stories in the Quran

Chapter 1: Types of Stories in the Qur'aan

1) Types of Stories in the Qur'aan:

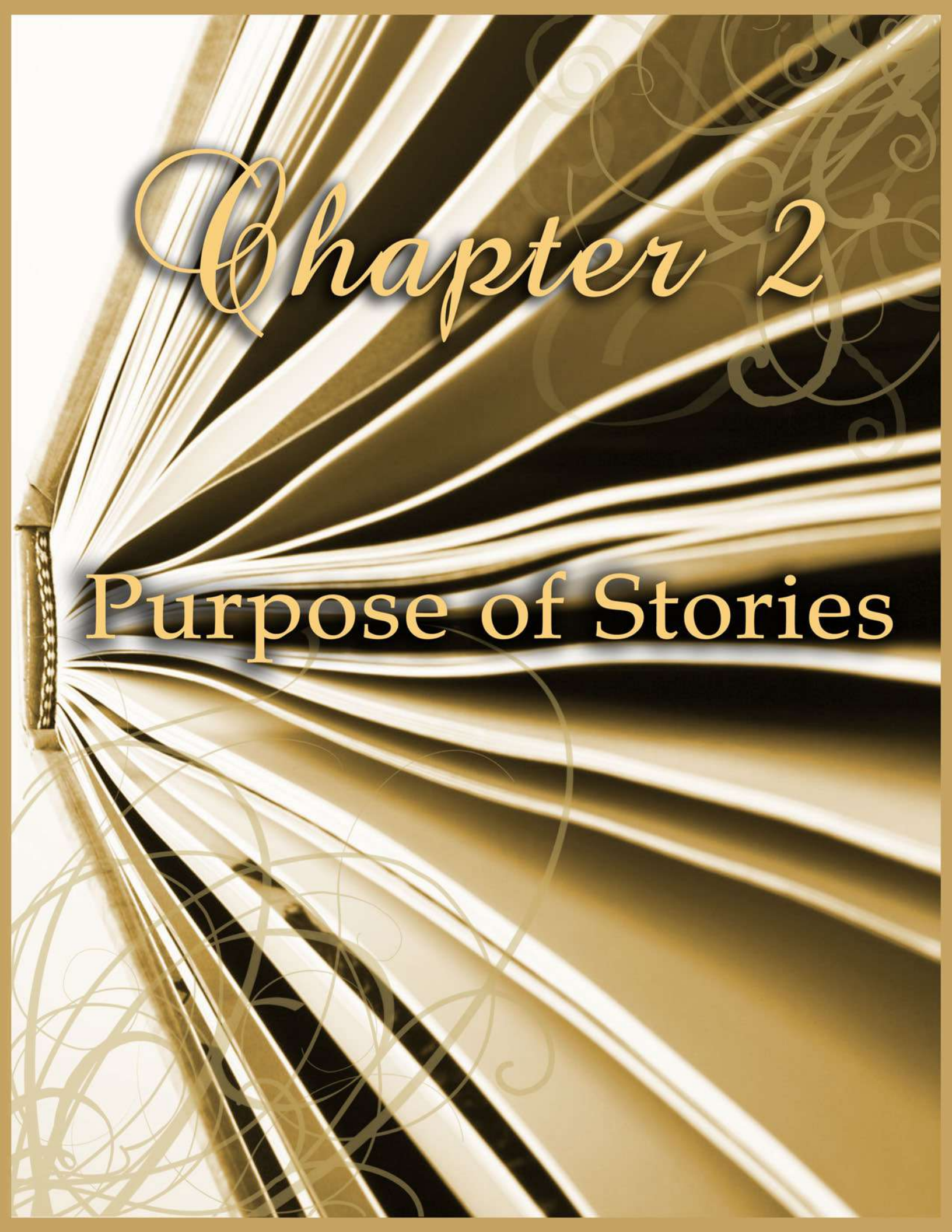
- a) About the prophets and messengers and what happened to their people
- b) About individuals/certain groups and what happened to them. (i.e. Luqman, Maryam, Dhul-Qarnayn)
- c) About the events that occurred at the time of the Prophet ﷺ

2) Qur'aan

The ayaat in the Qur'aan can be placed into three categories:

- a) Those that speak about tawheed
- b) Stories
- c) Ayaat related to halaal/haraam

Narrating stories is the best way to get a message across. This technique was also used in the Qur'aan to refute certain beliefs of non-Muslims.



Chapter 2

Purpose of Stories

Chapter 2: Purpose of Stories in the Qur'aan

Purpose of Stories in the Qur'aan:

a) To teach hikmah

Allaah ﷻ says:

وَلَقَدْ جَاءَهُمْ مِنَ الْأَنْبَاءِ مَا فِيهِ مُزْدَجَرٌ
حِكْمَةٌ بَالِغَةٌ فَمَا تُغْنِ النُّذُرُ

4. And indeed there has come to them news (in This Qur'ân) wherein there is (enough warning) to check (them from evil), 5. Perfect wisdom (this Qur'aan), but (the preaching of) warners benefit them not,

[Soorat Al-Qamar: 4-5]

- i. To establish and teach wisdom.
- ii. Wisdom is putting everything in its rightful place.
- iii. Responsibility of the prophets was to convey that which was revealed but to also teach the meaning and wisdom of the verses.
- iv. Wisdom is the sunnah of the Prophet ﷺ; when you learn and don't see what you learned being applied, the same effect doesn't occur. Hikmah is putting all those verses into practice as it is the sunnah of the Prophet ﷺ

"سئلت عائشة عن خلق رسول الله صلى الله عليه وسلم ، فقالت : كان خلقه القرآن"

Ai'shah رَضِيَ اللهُ عَنْهَا was asked how the character of the Prophet ﷺ was; she said his manners were the Qur'aan.

[Al-Albani]

- v. The examples in the Qur'aan are for us to reflect upon to make it easier for us.

b) To show the greatness of Allaah's ﷻ justice

Allaah ﷻ says:

وَمَا ظَلَمْنَاهُمْ وَلَكِنْ ظَلَمُوا أَنْفُسَهُمْ ۖ فَمَا أَغْنَتْ عَنْهُمْ آلِهَتُهُمُ الَّتِي يَدْعُونَ
مِنْ دُونِ اللَّهِ مِنْ شَيْءٍ لَمَّا جَاءَ أَمْرُ رَبِّكَ ۚ وَمَا زَادُوهُمْ غَيْرَ تَتَابُعٍ ﴿١٠١﴾

We wronged them not, but they wronged themselves. So their âliha (gods), other than Allâah, whom they invoked, profited them naught when there came the command of Your Lord, nor did they add aught (to their lot) but destruction.

[Soorat Hood: 101]

- i. Common theme in the stories: through all the trials and tribulations, Allaah ﷻ is always with the believers.
- ii. In the end Prophet Yusuf (عليه السلام) became in charge of all the riches.
- iii. Whatever you do, you'll see the result of it because Allaah ﷻ is just.

c) To give glad tidings to those who are grateful

Allaah ﷻ says:

إِنَّا أَرْسَلْنَا عَلَيْهِمْ حَاصِبًا إِلَّا آلَ لُوطٍ نَجَّيْنَاهُمْ بِسَحَرٍ ﴿٣٤﴾
نِعْمَةٌ مِّنْ عِنْدِنَا كَذَلِكَ نَجْزِي مَنْ شَكَرَ ﴿٣٥﴾

34. Verily, we sent against them a violent storm of stones (which destroyed them all), except the family of Loot (Lot), whom we saved In Last Hour of the night, 35. as a Favour from us, Thus do we reward Him who gives thanks (by obeying us).

[Soorat Al-Qamar: 34-34]

- i. These tidings are to help us to remain strong because in the end we know that the righteous will prevail.

d) To console the Messenger of Allaah ﷺ

- i. This soorah was revealed during the most difficult time of the Prophet's ﷺ life.

عن عائشة أنها قالت للنبي صلى الله عليه وسلم : هل أتى عليك يوم أشد من يوم أحد ؟ قال :
 "لقد لقيت من قومك ما لقيت ، وكان أشد ما لقيت منهم يوم العقبة ، إذ عرضت نفسي على ابن
 عبد ياليل بن عبد كلال ، فلم يجبني إلى ما أردت ، فانطلقت وأنا مهموم على وجهي ، فلم أستفق
 إلا وأنا بقرن الثعالب ، فرفعت رأسي ، فإذا أنا بسحابة قد أظلتني ، فنظرت فإذا فيها جبريل ،
 فناداني فقال : إن الله قد سمع قول قومك لك ، وما ردوا عليك ، وقد بعث الله إليك ملك الجبال
 ، لتأمره بما شئت فيهم ، فناداني ملك الجبال ، فسلم علي ، ثم قال : يا محمد ، فقال : " ذلك
 فيما شئت ، إن شئت أن أطبق عليهم الأخشبين ؟ فقال النبي صلى الله عليه وسلم : بل أرجو أن
 يخرج الله من أصلابهم من يعبد الله وحده ، لا يشرك به شيئا

Narrated 'Aisha: That she asked the Prophet, 'Have you encountered a day harder than the day of the battle) of Uhud?' the Prophet replied, "Your tribes have troubled me a lot, and the worse trouble was the trouble on the day of 'Aqaba when I presented myself to Ibn 'Abd-Yalail bin 'Abd-Kulal and he did not respond to my demand. So I departed, overwhelmed with excessive sorrow, and proceeded on, and could not relax till I found myself at Qarnath-Tha-alib where I lifted my head towards the sky to see a cloud shading me unexpectedly. I looked up and saw Gabriel in it. He called me saying, 'Allah has heard your people's saying to you, and what they have replied back to you, Allah has sent the angel of the mountains to you so that you may order him to do whatever you wish to these people.' the angel of the mountains called and greeted me, and then said, "O Muhammad! Order what you wish. If you like, I will let Al-Akh-Shabain (i.e. two mountains) fall on them." the Prophet said, "No but I hope that Allah will let them beget children who will worship Allah Alone, and will worship None besides Him."

[Saheeh Bukhari]

- ii. After the death of Abu Talib and Khadija ﷺ people disrespected the Prophet ﷺ openly and tried to injure him. It was then that this soorah was revealed.

e) To increase the faith and strength of the believers

Allaah ﷻ says:

وَلَقَدْ أَرْسَلْنَا مِنْ قَبْلِكَ رُسُلًا إِلَىٰ قَوْمِهِمْ فَجَاءَهُمْ بِالْبَيِّنَاتِ فَأَنْتَقَمْنَا مِنْ
الَّذِينَ أَجْرَمُوا ۖ وَكَانَ حَقًّا عَلَيْنَا نَصْرُ الْمُؤْمِنِينَ ﴿٤٧﴾

47. And indeed we did send Messengers before You (O Muhammad) to their own peoples. They came to them with clear proofs, then, we took vengeance on those who committed crimes (disbelief, setting partners In Worship with Allaah, sins, etc.), and (as for) the believers it was incumbent upon us to help (them).

[Soorat Ar-Room: 47]

- i. The believers can take Yusuf عليه السلام and his story as an example to help us when we are troubled, and know that when they place their trust in Allaah سُبْحَانَهُ they will be able to get out of any problems they face. We see that Yusuf عليه السلام went through trials and tribulations such as the ones his own brothers put him through, enduring servitude and being sold as a slave, the fitnah of the wife of Al-Azeez when she tried to seduce him, being accused of the worst of crimes that could ruin anyone's reputation, and even going to prison. He went through so much and his faith still remained strong.

f) To warn the disbelievers:

Allaah سُبْحَانَهُ says:

أَفَلَمْ يَسِيرُوا فِي الْأَرْضِ فَيَنْظُرُوا كَيْفَ كَانَ عَاقِبَةُ الَّذِينَ مِنْ قَبْلِهِمْ دَمَّرَ اللَّهُ
عَلَيْهِمْ وَلِلْكَافِرِينَ أَمْثَلُهَا ﴿١٠﴾

10. Have they not travelled through the earth, and seen what was the end of those before them? Allâh destroyed them completely and a similar (fate awaits) the disbelievers.

[Soorat Muhammad: 10]

g) To strengthen the message of the Prophet ﷺ

Allaah ﷻ says:

تِلْكَ مِنْ أَنْبَاءِ الْغَيْبِ نُوحِيهَا إِلَيْكَ مَا كُنْتَ تَعْلَمُهَا أَنْتَ وَلَا قَوْمُكَ مِنْ قَبْلِ
هَذَا فَاصْبِرْ إِنَّ الْعَاقِبَةَ لِلْمُتَّقِينَ ﴿٤٩﴾

49. This is of the news of the unseen which we reveal unto you (O Muhammad), neither you nor your people knew them before this. So be patient. Surely, the (good) end is for the Muttaqoon.

[Soorat Hood: 49]

Chapter 3

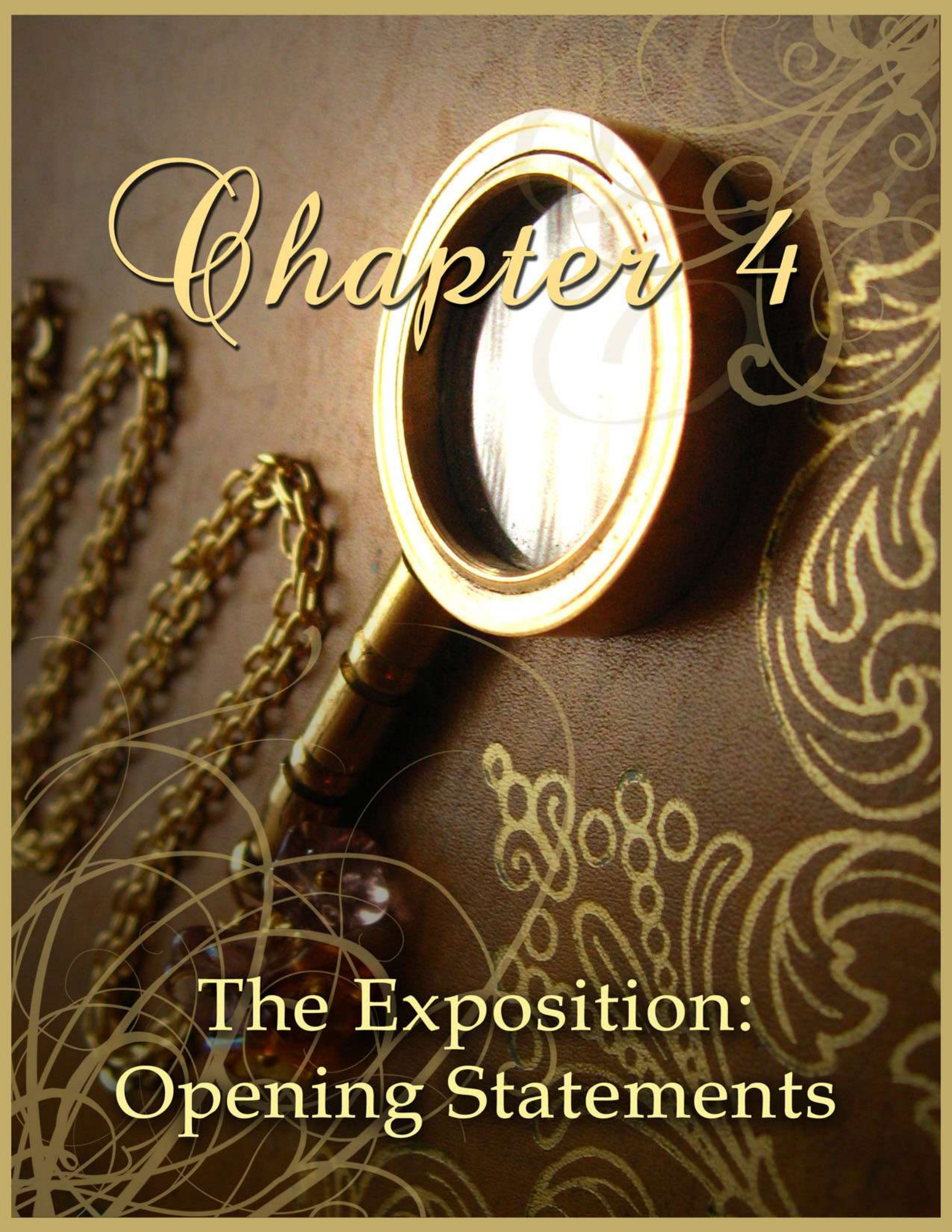
The Backdrop: Background of Surah Yusuf

Chapter 3: The Backdrop: Background of Soorah Yusuf

According to some scholars, this soorah was revealed in the 10th year of the Prophethood in Makkah. This year was also known as “Aam-ul-Huzn,” or the year of grief, because Muhammad ﷺ experienced the loss of two beloved individuals, Abu Talib and Khadija ﷺ. The Prophet ﷺ was both psychologically and physically grieved. With the passing away of his two closest supporters, the verbal and mental torture by his own nation and tribe members was amplified. Hence, Soorat Yusuf came as a relief and glad-tiding to the Prophet ﷺ.

It is also reported in some narrations that Jews wanted to test the Prophet ﷺ; hence, they sent some disbelievers of the Quraysh to enquire the Prophet ﷺ about the motive behind the migration of the family of Ya’qub, i.e. Israelites from Holy Land and (Jerusalem) to Egypt.

Since the Jews denied the Prophethood of our Messenger ﷺ despite clear signs, this question was put forth because they knew that Arabs were unaware of this narrative. Prophet ﷺ could not possibly have this knowledge and they knew that. Contrary to their expectations, Allaah ﷻ revealed the whole story of Prophet Yusuf ﷺ then and there and Muhammad ﷺ recited it on the spot.

The background of the slide features a dark brown, textured surface, possibly leather, with intricate, light-colored gold or brass scrollwork and floral patterns. A magnifying glass with a gold-colored frame and handle is positioned diagonally across the upper half of the image. A gold-colored chain is draped across the lower left portion of the image. The overall lighting is warm and focused on the magnifying glass.

Chapter 4

The Exposition: Opening Statements

Chapter 4: The Exposition: Opening Statements

Aayaat 1-3

Allaah ﷻ says:

الرَّ تِلْكَ ءَايَاتُ الْكِتَابِ الْمُبِينِ ﴿١﴾ إِنَّا أَنْزَلْنَاهُ قُرْآنًا عَرَبِيًّا لَعَلَّكُمْ تَعْقِلُونَ ﴿٢﴾
نَحْنُ نَقُصُّ عَلَيْكَ أَحْسَنَ الْقَصَصِ بِمَا أَوْحَيْنَا إِلَيْكَ هَذَا الْقُرْآنَ وَإِنْ كُنْتَ مِنْ
قَبْلِهِ لَمِنَ الْغَافِلِينَ ﴿٣﴾

1. Alif, Lâ, Râ. These are the verses of the clear Book. 2. Indeed, We have sent it down as an Arabic Qur'aan that you might understand. 3. We relate to you, [O Muhammad], the best of stories in that We have revealed to you of this Qur'aan although you were, before it, among the unaware.

[Soorat Yoosuf: 1-3]

Aayah 1

Allaah ﷻ starts this Surah with the letters Alif, Lam, Ra. What do these letters mean? The scholars of Islam have differed over what their meanings are.

- Some are of the opinion that these letters have been revealed and we do not know what the meanings are.
- Some have interpreted their meaning.

عن ابن عباس في قوله تعالى: { اَلَمْ } يقول ألف الله لام جبريل ميم محمد

[تفسير الفيروز آبادي]

Ibn 'Abbas said, concerning Allah's saying, Exalted is He, (Alif. Lam. Mim): 'Alif stands for Allah, Lam for the Archangel Gabriel (Jibril) and Mim for Muhammad.

[Tafsir Al-FayroozAbadi]

However, this is a weak narration, and as such, we do not have any substantial proof to tell us what these letters really mean.

- Some scholars have said these letters are a challenge to the Arabs. Alif, Lam, Raa. In total there are 14 letters that have been mentioned at the beginning of Suwar. The Arabic language consists of 28 main letters. Some of the scholars say these are letters that are familiar to us and that form our speech and languages. This Qur'aan is also composed of these letters that we use but it is not the same as our speech! These letters are a challenge in that Allah ﷻ has used 14 of them and He challenges us to bring forth a Surah or aayah similar to the Qur'aan from the remaining 14.
- o The proof for this is that every time Allaah ﷻ speaks about or mentions these letters, He speaks about the Qur'aan immediately afterwards.
For example:

Allaah ﷻ says:

الم ذَٰلِكَ الْكِتَابُ ...

1. Alif-Lâm-Mîm. 2. This is the Book (the Qur'ân), ...

[Soorat al-Baqarah: 1-2]

Aayah means a sign or miracle. Every verse of the Qur'aan is a miracle. If you know Arabic you know that these *aayaat* are from Allaah ﷻ. Those who heard them were shocked and in awe. Even the same *aayah*, heard many times before, can still strike you if you reflect upon it. Imagine how this must have been for the people for whom this was a part of their language. How can we understand this? Imagine you have a basket of marbles and you throw it into the air and they all fall into place to form the perfect image of your house. What are the chances of that? If this was on YouTube it would go viral; people would say you faked it. If it was real they'd call it a miracle. If it happened just once, perhaps it would be considered a miracle. Say you do it again and this time the marbles form into the shape of your car. This would be superhuman, impossible. That is what the revelation of the Qur'aan was like- *aayah* after *aayah*. People would sneak at night to listen to the recitation of the Prophet ﷺ even though they did not believe in

the message. Many people embraced Islam as soon as they heard the Qur'aan. They knew immediately that this could not have been created by a human.

Al kitaab is that which is collected and put together. The Qur'aan here is referred to as the clear Book. *Al kitaab al mubeen* clarifies what is Halaal and Haraam, tawHeed, how to worship Allaah ﷻ, the stories of the past that the people did not know, as well as information regarding the future.

Aayah 2

Scholars have used this *aayah* to prove that Allaah ﷻ is above His throne, above the heavens since the Qur'aan itself was sent down from above. How then do we reconcile this with the following Hadeeth that He descends in the last third part of the night?

عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهُ أَنَّ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ قَالَ يَنْزِلُ رَبُّنَا تَبَارَكَ وَتَعَالَى كُلَّ لَيْلَةٍ إِلَى السَّمَاءِ الدُّنْيَا حِينَ يَبْقَى ثُلُثُ اللَّيْلِ الْآخِرِ يَقُولُ مَنْ يَدْعُونِي فَأَسْتَجِيبَ لَهُ مَنْ يَسْأَلُنِي فَأُعْطِيَهُ مَنْ يَسْتَغْفِرُنِي فَأَغْفِرَ لَهُ

Abu Huraira narrates that Allah's Apostle said, "When it is the last third of the night, our Lord, the Blessed, the Superior, descends every night to the heaven of the world and says, 'Is there anyone who invokes Me (demand anything from Me), that I may respond to his invocation; is there anyone who asks Me for something that I may give (it to) him; is there anyone who asks My forgiveness that I may forgive him?'"

[Saheeh Al Bukhari]

We affirm about Allaah ﷻ what He affirms for Himself. If He says He has a Face, He has one that is appropriate for His Magnificence. Is it like ours? No. If He says He has hands is it like ours? Are our hands like those of a clock? They are not the same. Allaah ﷻ can hear us right now as well as everyone on the other side of the planet. If we are listening to one person and another begins talking to us, we would get confused. When we say He is above and descends He can do so, He can be above and descend at the same time. If Allaah ﷻ uses phrases and words to describe Himself, we affirm them.

Moreover, every creation of Allaah ﷻ knows Allaah ﷻ is above them whether they attest to it or not. When one says, “Oh my God!” their naturally raise their hands.

The word *kitaab* is different from Qur’aan. When the Qur’aan was revealed it was not a book. *Qur’aan*, itself, means to recite. The collecting or putting together isn’t necessarily physical. **Takattaba** jaysh: when the army is scattered and the trumpet is blown so troops come together; all the ideas come together to form a *kitaab*.

When tafsir is done first of all one looks at the words of Allaah ﷻ and tries to look for an explanation from the Qur’aan. Next, the ahadeeth from the Prophet ﷺ explaining the *aayah*, are explored. Next, one looks to the Companions, for if they applied it incorrectly during the lifetime of the Prophet ﷺ, he would have corrected them. After that you look at the linguistics, the Arabic language itself, because the Qur’aan was revealed in Arabic. *Hut* for one Prophet ﷺ meant whale, yet for Musa ﷺ en route to Khidr ﷺ it meant fish. You have to go back to *their* language.

Thus, there is value the fact that the Qur’aan is in Arabic. It was sent down in the language of the people. *Ta’qiloon* means to reflect and understand. Language itself is subject to change over time. This can be due to a variety of reasons including the changes in language from region to region or due to economic trading. The Qur’aan was revealed to the Prophet ﷺ in Arabic so that the people could understand it. Some scholars say it is makrooh to hang up *aayaat* of the Qur’aan as decoration as this is an act of disrespect. The Qur’aan is a book that is meant to be recited, reflected upon, applied, and appreciated but not as an adornment.

Aayah 3

Allaah ﷻ calls this the best of stories. The word *qaSaS* means to go back and retrace what has occurred. *QiSaaS* are stories that can be true or may be fiction, *qaSaS* are stories that are true. Allaah ﷻ relates to us that the story of Yoosuf is true.

In order to understand an *aayah* correctly we need something called *asbaab an nazool*, the context or circumstance of the revelation of particular *aayaat*.

عن سعد بن أبي وقاص : أنزل القرآن على رسول الله ، فتلا عليهم زمانا ، فقالوا : يا رسول الله لو قصصت علينا ، فأنزل الله تبارك وتعالى : { الر تلك آيات الكتاب المبين } إلى قوله : { نحن نقص عليك أحسن القصص } ، فتلا عليهم رسول الله صلى الله عليه وسلم زمانا ، فقالوا : يا رسول الله ! لو حدثتنا ، فأنزل الله : { الله نزل أحسن الحديث كتابا متشابها { الآية ، كل ذلك يؤمرون بالقرآن . قال خلاد : وزاد [ني] فيه آخر قالوا : يا رسول الله ! ذكرنا ، فأنزل الله

ألم يأن للذين آمنوا أن تخشع قلوبهم لذكر الله { : {

[الألْباني]

..."They said, `O, Allah's Messenger! Why not narrate to us stories' Later on, this Ayah was revealed,

نَحْنُ نَقُصُّ عَلَيْكَ أَحْسَنَ الْقَصَصِ

We relate unto you the best of stories..."

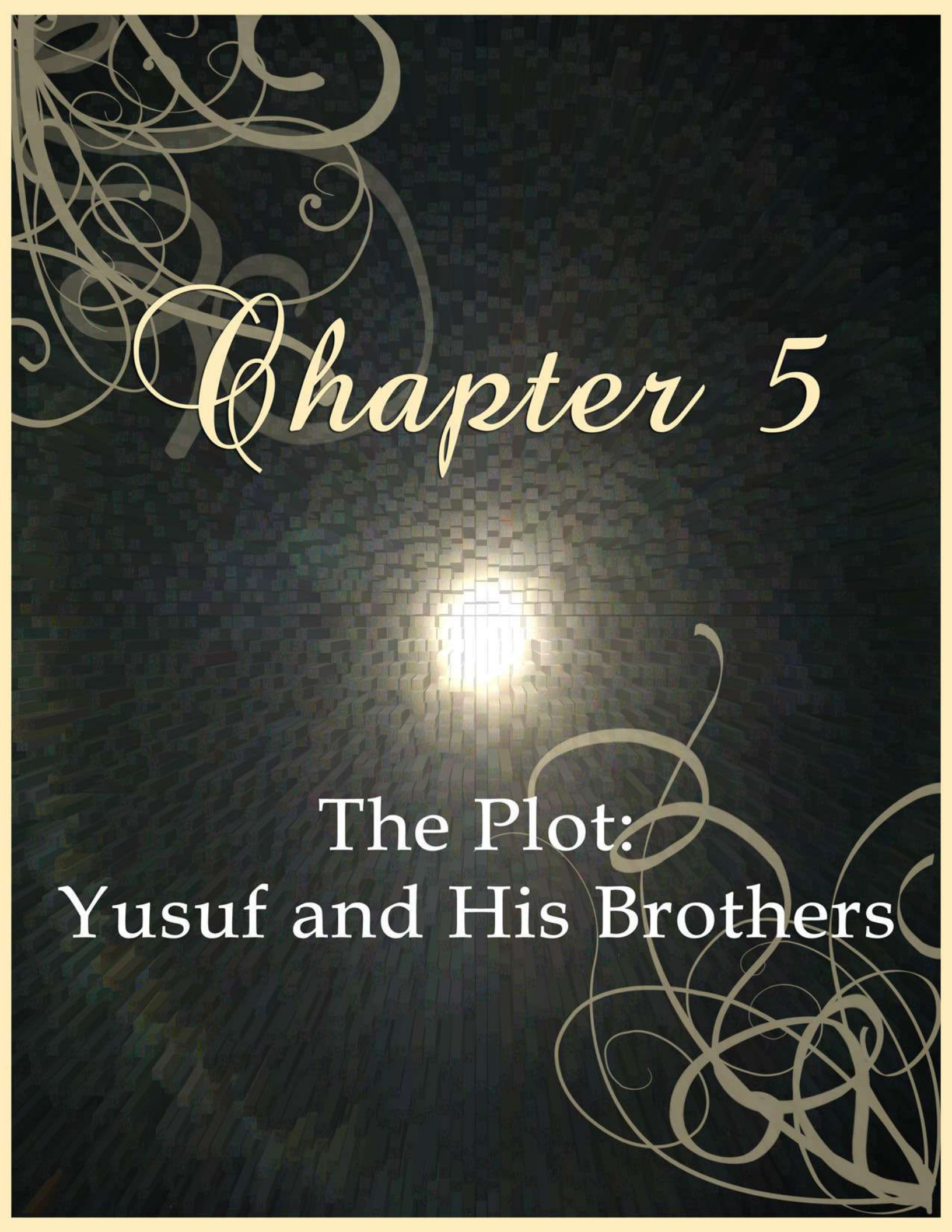
[Al-Albani]

Allaah ﷻ says that before this revelation the Prophet Muhammad ﷺ was amongst those who were *al ghaafireen*, those were unaware. Before this revelation, the story of Yoosuf ﷺ was not known to them. This story is also in the Bible as the story of Joseph, however not in such detail or magnitude.

Reflections

1. The majority opinion of scholars regarding the meaning of the miraculous letters is that this is known only to Allaah ﷻ.
2. Allah ﷻ called the Qur'aan "the Book" though it was not an actual book.
3. The Qur'aan is clear guidance from Allaah ﷻ.

4. Allaah ﷻ addresses the Arabs and said to them “so that you may understand.”
5. Allaah ﷻ favored Arabic over other languages.
6. The greatest blessing Allaah ﷻ can give to anyone is Islam. The greatest blessing is to be a Prophet and Messenger.
7. Allaah ﷻ only tells the best of stories.
8. The Qur’aan is for those who reflect.
9. The Prophet of Allaah ﷺ did not know the story of Yoosuf before Allaah ﷻ blessed him with revelation.



Chapter 5

The Plot:
Yusuf and His Brothers

Chapter 5: The Plot: Yoosuf and His Brothers

Aayaat 4-6

Allaah ﷻ says:

إِذْ قَالَ يُوسُفُ لِأَبِيهِ يَا أَبَتِ إِنِّي رَأَيْتُ أَحَدَ عَشَرَ كَوْكَبًا وَالشَّمْسَ وَالْقَمَرَ رَأَيْتُهُمْ لِي
سَاجِدِينَ ﴿٤﴾ قَالَ يَبْنَىٰ لَا تَقْصُصْ رُءْيَاكَ عَلَىٰ إِخْوَتِكَ فَيَكِيدُوا لَكَ كَيْدًا ۖ إِنَّ
الشَّيْطَانَ لِلْإِنسَانِ عَدُوٌّ مُّبِينٌ ﴿٥﴾ وَكَذَلِكَ نَجْتِبِيكَ رَبُّكَ وَيُعَلِّمُكَ مِن تَأْوِيلِ
الْأَحَادِيثِ وَيُتِمُّ نِعْمَتَهُ عَلَيْكَ وَعَلَىٰ ءَالِ يَعْقُوبَ كَمَا أَتَمَّهَا عَلَىٰ أَبَوَيْكَ مِن قَبْلُ
إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَإِسْحَاقَ ۚ إِنَّ رَبَّكَ عَلِيمٌ حَكِيمٌ ﴿٦﴾

4. [Of these stories mention] when Joseph said to his father, "O my father, indeed I have seen [in a dream] eleven stars and the sun and the moon; I saw them prostrating to me." 5. He said, "O my son, do not relate your vision to your brothers or they will contrive against you a plan. Indeed Satan, to man, is a manifest enemy. 6. And thus will your Lord choose you and teach you the interpretation of narratives and complete His favor upon you and upon the family of Jacob, as He completed it upon your fathers before, Abraham and Isaac. Indeed, your Lord is Knowing and Wise."

[Soorat Yoosuf: 4-6]

Attention!

Imagine: Prophet Yoosuf ﷺ and his father ﷺ were in a desert. A young boy approached his father. This scene immediately captures the reader's attention. Remember when Allaah ﷻ said that this is the best of stories. Those who narrate stories have taken their

lessons from the Qur'aan. Some stories, or movies, may begin with a scene but you don't understand. Perhaps someone guy is running and is being gunned down. Who is this? What is going on? Sometimes there is a violent scene, a murder and a person you do not know with a scar on his face who just disappears. You do not know what is happening but you are captivated and as you continue to watch, things begin to make sense.

Aayah 4

Look at how Allaah ﷻ informs us of Prophet Yoosuf's ﷺ manners towards his father ﷺ, he doesn't say, "Ya Baba!" Rather, he says "Ya abati" or "O my father!," which indicates respect and politeness.

The description of stars, the sun, and the moon prostrating to a person is something strange and, thereby, grabs your attention. Notice also that "I saw" is repeated. Some scholars say there is an implied meaning in that when Yoosuf ﷺ told his father the dream his father may have asked of him what he saw next and Yoosuf ﷺ answered him.

Aayah 5

إن الكريم ابن الكريم ابن الكريم يوسف بن يعقوب بن إسحاق بن إبراهيم خليل الرحمن
تبارك و تعالى

Someone once asked who is the most noble among the people and the Messenger of Allaah ﷺ replied: The kareem is ibn Kareem ibn Kareem ibn Kareem, a noble, son of a noble, son of a noble, son of a noble Yoosuf ibn Yaqoob ibn IsHaaq ibn Ibrahim the friend of the Most Merciful the exalted .

[Tirmidhee]

Prophet Yoosuf ﷺ is the son of Prophet Ya'qoob ﷺ, son of Prophet Isha'q ﷺ, son of Prophet Ibrahim ﷺ. Prophet Ya'qoob's ﷺ nickname was Isra'eel. It is also known about Yoosuf that he was given half the beauty of mankind; the other half of beauty was distributed amongst the rest of us.

Both father and son had endearing manners. Ya'qoob called his son “*Ya bunaya*” or “O my little son,” which is a form of kindness. Through this example, we see that we should speak to children in a kind way—a way in which we wish to be addressed.

Prophet Ya'qoob عليه السلام knew, upon hearing this dream, that it was something good. Dreams are the first stage of revelation of Prophets. He warned his son against sharing this with his brothers as they will plot against him. Ya'qoob عليه السلام has an understanding of dreams as well as the character of people.

There are different types of dreams. Some are from Allaah ﷻ, some are from ShayTaan, and others are from our nafs, our subconscious. If a dream is from Allaah ﷻ, you will remember it and it will have an effect on you. If a dream is related to fear of the Hereafter and it pushes you to do good then it may be from Allaah ﷻ. If a dream has calamities occurring in this life then this is from ShayTaan; do not let this stop you from going about your daily life because the ShayTaan is trying to scare you. Seek refuge with Allaah ﷻ and do not share it with others. The third type of dream is a dream from the subconscious, which is simply related to the things on your mind; most people have these dreams and do not remember them.

Can a person learn about the future through dreams? Not necessarily as one can never be 100% sure the dream was from Allaah ﷻ, let alone entirely from Him, until it happens. Prophets, however, only have true dreams, i.e., dreams that are from Allaah ﷻ. The more truthful you are the more true your dreams will be.

قال رسول الله ﷺ: أصدقهم رؤيا أصدقهم حديثا

The Prophet ﷺ said whoever is more truthful in their speech the more truthful their dreams will be.

[Abu Dawood]

When it comes to interpreting dreams there are some patterns and symbolism (such as swimming signifying knowledge or nakedness symbolizing that one needs deen). However, real dream interpretation requires someone with the talent, the gift; it is not something that can be taught, picked up, or learned. Dreams should only be shared with those one really trusts as they may spur jealousy. Jealousy is when one desires something another has in such a way they wish the person did not have that blessing.

Some scholars say that the last part of this ayah, “Indeed Satan, to man, is a manifest enemy,” is a continuation of what Prophet Ya’qoob ﴿ٱلْعَلِيَّة﴾ said to Prophet Yoosuf ﴿ٱلْعَلِيَّة﴾. Some say it is Allaah ﴿ٱلْعَلِيَّة﴾ speaking to us. ShayTaan is any person or jinn that is disobedient to Allaah ﴿ٱلْعَلِيَّة﴾ and/or calls to disobedience to Allaah ﴿ٱلْعَلِيَّة﴾. ShayTaan is not a name; it is a description. The leader of the ShayTaan is Iblees. The jinn are invisible and it is impossible for us to see them in their natural form; they are made of fire so they can take any form. ShayTeen are dangerous, especially the jinn amongst the ShayTeen as they have powers and are our enemies. The lesson in the jinn being invisible is that although they can affect or attack us from where we cannot see them, we seek help and refuge with Allaah ﴿ٱلْعَلِيَّة﴾ who sees all things.

Prophet Ya’qoob ﴿ٱلْعَلِيَّة﴾ warned his son that if the dream is shared, ShayTaan will whisper to his brothers, arousing their jealousy, and they will plot against him.

Aayah 6

Allaah ﴿ٱلْعَلِيَّة﴾ gave Prophet Yoosuf ﴿ٱلْعَلِيَّة﴾ the knowledge of interpretation of dreams and completed His favors upon him through giving him Prophethood as well.

Indeed Allaah ﴿ٱلْعَلِيَّة﴾ is All-Knowing and Wise with the blessings He has bestowed upon people. There should be no jealousy because this is what Allaah ﴿ٱلْعَلِيَّة﴾ had decreed.

Reflections

Allaah ﴿ٱلْعَلِيَّة﴾ says that Soorat Yoosuf is the best of stories. Scholars say this is so because it encompasses a variety of essential topics including ‘aqeedah, societal problems, travelers, the home, family, plots, lust, passion, women gossiping, father and child relationships, jealousy in households, kings, slaves, droughts, hunger, and so on.

Aayaat 7-10

Allaah ﷻ says:

لَقَدْ كَانَ فِي يُوسُفَ وَإِخْوَتِهِ ءَايَاتٌ لِّلَّسَّائِلِينَ ﴿٧﴾ إِذْ قَالُوا لِيُوسُفُ وَأَخُوهُ أَحَبُّ
إِلَىٰ آبِنَا مِنَّا وَخَنُّ عُصْبَةٍ إِنَّ أَبَانَا لَفِي ضَلَالٍ مُّبِينٍ ﴿٨﴾ أَقْتُلُوا يُوسُفَ أَوْ اطْرَحُوهُ
أَرْضًا يَخْلُ لَكُمْ وَجْهُ أَبِيكُمْ وَتَكُونُوا مِن بَعْدِهِ قَوْمًا صَالِحِينَ ﴿٩﴾ قَالَ قَائِلٌ مِّنْهُمْ
لَا تَقْتُلُوا يُوسُفَ وَأَلْقُوهُ فِي غَيِّبَتِ الْجُبِّ يَلْتَقِطْهُ بَعْضُ السَّيَّارَةِ إِن كُنتُمْ فَاعِلِينَ ﴿١٠﴾

7. Certainly were there in Joseph and his brothers signs for those who ask, 8. When they said, “Joseph and his brother are more beloved to our father than we, while we are a clan. Indeed, our father is in clear error. 9. Kill Joseph or cast him out to [another] land; the countenance of your father will [then] be only for you, and you will be after that a righteous people.” 10. Said a speaker among them, “Do not kill Joseph but throw him into the bottom of the well; some travelers will pick him up – if you would do [something].”

[Soorat Yoosuf: 7-10]

Aayah 7

Allaah ﷻ does not say that there are *ayaat* for those who reflect. He says there are *ayaat* for those who ask. If we want to know the story, it's very clear. This is proof of the Messenger's ﷺ Prophethood as being unlettered he could not have read any previous scriptures, nor are such details found in other stories.

Aayah 8

In these aayaat, Yoosuf's brothers are talking about him ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾ and his brother, Benjamin. Benjamin may also be referred to as Benjamin in the book of the Israaeeliaat, however, we do not know for sure. Prophet Ya'qoob ﴿يَاْقُوْبَ﴾ had more than one wife; Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾ and Benjamin were born from the same mother.

It is not wrong to love one child more than others, since this is an emotion, but it is wrong to be unjust to them. If you give something to one child, you must give something of similar value to the others as well.

النُّعْمَانُ بْنُ بَشِيرٍ : " أَنَّ أُمَّهُ بِنْتُ رَوَاحَةَ سَأَلَتْ أَبَاهُ بَعْضَ الْمَوْهَبَةِ مِنْ مَالِهِ لِابْنِهَا ، فَالْتَوَى بِهَا سَنَةً ثُمَّ بَدَأَ لَهُ ، فَقَالَتْ : لَا أَرْضَى حَتَّى تُشْهَدَ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ عَلَى مَا وَهَبْتَ لِابْنِي ، فَأَخَذَ أَبِي يَدَيَّ وَأَنَا يَوْمَئِذٍ غُلَامٌ ، فَاتَى رَسُولَ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ ، فَقَالَ : يَا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ ، إِنَّ أُمَّ هَذَا بِنْتَ رَوَاحَةَ أَعْجَبَهَا أَنْ أُشْهَدَكَ عَلَى الَّذِي وَهَبْتُ لِابْنِهَا ، فَقَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ : يَا بَشِيرُ أَلَاكَ وَلَدٌ سِوَى هَذَا ؟ قَالَ : نَعَمْ ، فَقَالَ : أَكُلُّهُمْ وَهَبْتَ لَهُ مِثْلَ هَذَا ؟ قَالَ : لَا ، قَالَ : فَلَا تُشْهَدْنِي إِذَا . " . فَإِنِّي لَا أَشْهَدُ عَلَى جَوْرٍ

Nu'man b. Bashir reported that his mother bint Rawaha asked his (Nu'man's) father about donating some gifts from his property to his son. He deferred the matter by one year, and then set forth to do that. She (Nu'man's mother) said: I shall not be pleased unless you call Allah's Messenger (may peace be upon him) as witness to what you confer as a gift on your son. (Nu'man said): So father took hold of my hand and I was at that time a boy, and came to Allah's Messenger (may peace be upon him). and said: Allah's Messenger, the mother of this son (of mine), daughter of Rawaha wishes that I should call you witness to what I confer as gift to her son. Allah's Messenger (may peace be upon him) said: Bashir, have you any other son besides this (son of yours)? He said: Yes. He (the Holy Prophet) said: Have you given gifts to all of them like this? He said: No. Thereupon he (the Holy Prophet) said: Then call me not as witness, for I cannot be witness to an injustice.

[Muslim]

It is clear to the brothers that Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾ and Benjamin are the most beloved to their father; they thought they as a group could benefit their father more. They felt their father was not being

just to them due to his love of Yoosuf and Benjamin. When your kids feel you are being unjust, they are more likely to be disobedient. Prophet Ya'qoob (عليه السلام) did not treat his children unfairly.

Aayah 9

Jealousy can make a person think irrationally. In this case, one of the brothers said that they should kill Yoosuf (عليه السلام) in order to cause their father to turn his attention towards them. They did not focus their efforts on Benjamin because he was very young so the enmity against him was not as great. The actions of the brothers show that just because a person is pious, this does not necessitate that their children will be pious as well; Allaah (سبحانه) can test us. We can ask Allaah (سبحانه) to put blessings in our children- if not they could be the cause of our grief. If blessings are given then children can be of help and put joy into the hearts of their parents. It is important to ask Allaah (سبحانه) to place barakah, or blessings, upon our families and children.

This plotting is from the tricks of Shaytaan. Shaytaan will make you feel better about doing something convincing you that it is okay and that you would never do such a thing again. If you have not yet committed the sin, then don't do it and have the intention to change after. Simply just do not commit the sin.

The brothers do not achieve their goal because Ya'qoob (عليه السلام) never stops thinking about Yoosuf (عليه السلام) even after the passing of many years. One cannot please Allaah (سبحانه) by doing something that is displeasing to Him, e.g. building a masjid by taking a mortgage that has interest on it. While the goal of increasing their father's love is not inherently evil, the ends do not justify the means. However, there are some exceptions, such as "lying" to bring together two people who have a grudge against each other.

عن أمّ كلثوم بنت عقبة بن أبي معيط وكانت من المهاجرات الأول اللاتي بايعن النبي صلى الله عليه وسلم أخبرته أنها سمعت رسول الله صلى الله عليه وسلم وهو يقول ليس الكذاب الذي يصلح بين الناس ويقول خيراً وينمي خيراً قال ابن شهاب ولم أسمع يُرخص في شيء مما يقول الناس كذب إلا في ثلاث الحرب والإصلاح بين الناس وحديث الرجل امرأته وحديث المرأة زوجها

Umm Kulthum daughter of 'Uqba b. Abu Mu'ait, and she was one amongst the first emigrants who pledged allegiance to Allah's Apostle (may peace be upon him), as saying that she heard Allah's Messenger (may peace be upon him) as saying: A liar is

not one who tries to bring reconciliation amongst people and speaks good (in order to avert dispute), or he conveys good. Ibn Shihab said he did not hear that exemption was granted in anything what the people speak as lie but in three cases: in battle, for bringing reconciliation amongst persons and the narration of the words of the husband to his wife

[Muslim]

Aayah 10

Some of the scholars say that the speaker in this *aayah* is the eldest brother. He was aware of the conviction that his brothers had in their willingness to kill their own brother, Yoosuf عليه السلام. He recommended an alternative to murder- leaving him in a well. In our shari'ah, if a sin cannot be avoided altogether, pick between the lesser of the two evils.

In this ayah, *al jubb* is a well whose hole gets bigger towards the bottom. Some of the scholars have said that this particular well was just a hole. *Al sayyaarah* were a type of traveling people who went back and forth on a regular basis; they are usually merchants.

Aayaat 11-15

Allaah ﷻ says:

قَالُوا يَتَّابَانَا مَا لَكَ لَا تَأْمَنَّا عَلَى يُوسُفَ وَإِنَّا لَهُ لَنَصِحُونَ ﴿١١﴾ أَرْسَلَهُ مَعَنَا غَدًا يَرْتَع وَيَلْعَب وَإِنَّا لَهُ لَحَافِظُونَ ﴿١٢﴾ قَالَ إِنِّي لَيَحْزُنُنِي أَنْ تَذْهَبُوا بِهِ وَأَخَافُ أَنْ يَأْكُلَهُ الذِّئْبُ وَأَنْتُمْ عَنْهُ غَافِلُونَ ﴿١٣﴾ قَالُوا لَئِنْ أَكَلَهُ الذِّئْبُ وَنَحْنُ عُصْبَةٌ إِنَّا إِذًا لَّخَسِرُونَ ﴿١٤﴾ فَلَمَّا ذَهَبُوا بِهِ وَاجْمَعُوا أَنْ يَجْعَلُوهُ فِي غِيَّبَتِ الْجُبِّ وَأَوْحَيْنَا إِلَيْهِ لَتُنَبِّئَهُمْ بِأَمْرِهِمْ هَذَا وَهُمْ لَا يَشْعُرُونَ ﴿١٥﴾

11. They said, "O our father, why do you not entrust us with Joseph while indeed, we are to him sincere counselors? 12. Send him with us tomorrow that he may eat well and play. And indeed, we will be his guardians. 13. [Jacob] said, "Indeed, it saddens me that you should take him, and I fear that a wolf would eat him while you are of him unaware." 14. They said, "If a wolf should eat him while we are a [strong] clan, indeed, we would then be losers." 15. So when they took him [out] and agreed to put him into the bottom of the well... But We inspired to him, "You will surely inform them [someday] about this affair of theirs while they do not perceive [your identity]."

[Soorat Yoosuf: 11-15]

Aayah 11

Ya'qoob ﷺ loved Yoosuf ﷺ so much that they were always together; he never let him out of his sight. The very thought of separating was painful.

In this *aayah*, the brothers say "inna"- indeed, they are sincere counselors to him. In the Arabic language there are no punctuation marks for emphasis; instead this is incorporated into the

language itself. Emotions are inherently included in the Arabic language. For example, in the following *aayah*, it is as though there are at least three exclamation points at the end of it. Allah ﷻ says,

إِنَّ الْإِنْسَانَ لِفِي خُسْرٍ

2. Verily! Man is in loss,

[Soorat Al 'Asr: 2]

In this *aayah*, the word *naseeHa* means good advice. Although they had evil inclinations, they claimed they only have good intentions for Yoosuf ﷺ.

Aayah 12

What is it that the brothers wanted from Ya'qoob ﷺ? *Yarta'* means to go out or to go out and eat. They want their father to send Yoosuf ﷺ to eat and play with them. Again the indeed here is used with emphasis; they also say “we” consistently to show they can be trusted, that they will definitely take good care of him.

Aayah 13

The probability of Yoosuf ﷺ being eaten by a wolf were very slim so it may not have been the case that Prophet Ya'qoob ﷺ was really concerned about wolves. Some scholars have interpreted this as fear of the brothers harming him. Islamically, accusations should not be based on the intentions of others. It is not our job to look at the intentions of people. Ya'qoob ﷺ did not want to hurt his sons or make them feel uncomfortable by saying that he did not trust them, nor did he lie as the possibility of being eaten by a wolf does exist.

Aayah 14

They tried to address and ease their fathers concerns. How could a wolf eat him while he would be protected by being in a large group with them? They were trying to reassure him that Yoosuf عليه السلام would be brought back safely.

The plots they made were motivated by *hasad*, or jealousy. Jealousy occurs when you see someone else blessed with something and you want them to no longer have that blessing; sometimes you want that blessing for yourself. It is something that destroys good deeds. A Muslim should not be jealous of another; if Allaah ﷻ wanted you to have something, you would have been given it. When you see someone has something good make du'aa that Allaah ﷻ blesses him. Say *masha'Allaah, la howla wala quwata illa billah*, meaning: it is the will of Allaah ﷻ (the blessing is from Him), there is no power except that it is from Allaah ﷻ. We are taught to always seek the blessings of Allah ﷻ, which is part of the beauty of Islaam because while Shaytaan and our nafs steer us towards sin, Islam steers us away from it.

Envy can have very serious repercussions:

رَأَى عَامِرُ بْنُ رَبِيعَةَ سَهْلَ بْنَ حُنَيْفٍ يَغْتَسِلُ فَقَالَ مَا رَأَيْتُ كَالْيَوْمِ وَلَا جِلْدَ مُخْبَأَةٍ فَلَبِطَ سَهْلٌ فَأُتِيَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ فَقِيلَ يَا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ هَلْ لَكَ فِي سَهْلِ بْنِ حُنَيْفٍ وَاللَّهِ مَا يَرْفَعُ رَأْسَهُ فَقَالَ هَلْ تَتَّهِمُونَ لَهُ أَحَدًا قَالُوا نَتَّهِمُ عَامِرَ بْنَ رَبِيعَةَ قَالَ فَدَعَا رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ عَامِرًا فَتَغَيَّظَ عَلَيْهِ وَقَالَ عَلَامَ يَقْتُلُ أَحَدُكُمْ أَخَاهُ إِلَّا بِرَكْتٍ اغْتَسِلَ لَهُ فغَسَلَ عَامِرٌ وَجْهَهُ وَيَدَيْهِ وَمِرْفَقَيْهِ وَرُكْبَتَيْهِ وَأَطْرَافَ رِجْلَيْهِ وَدَاخِلَةَ إِزَارِهِ فِي قَدَحٍ ثُمَّ صَبَّ عَلَيْهِ فَرَّاحَ سَهْلٍ مَعَ النَّاسِ لَيْسَ بِهِ بَأْسٌ

"Amir ibn Rabia saw Sahl ibn Hunayf doing a ghusl and said, 'I have not seen the like of what I see today, not even the skin of a maiden who has never been out of doors.' Sahl fell to the ground. The Messenger of Allah, may Allah bless him and grant him peace, was approached and it was said, 'Messenger of Allah, can you do anything about Sahl ibn Hunayf? By Allah, he can not raise his head.' He said, 'Do you suspect anyone of it?' They said, 'We suspect Amir ibn Rabia.' " He continued, "The Messenger of Allah, may Allah bless him and grant him peace, summoned

Amir and was furious with him and said, 'Why does one of you kill his brother? Why did you not say, "May Allah bless you?" Do ghusl for it.' Amir washed his face, hands, elbows, knees, the end of his feet, and inside his lower garment in a vessel. Then he poured it over him, and Sahl went off with the people, and there was nothing wrong with him."

[Malik]

You may have a beautiful car yet be envious of a luxury car though there are people who do not even have means of transportation. They can't even dream of cars—they have a dream bicycle! Think of the people who have less than you. This will help you to be grateful and appreciative of Allaah's ﷻ blessings.

It is permissible to be jealous of two types of people provided we are jealous without wishing for the blessing to be detracted from them:

1. One who knows the Qur'aan and recites it day and night,
2. Someone who Allaah ﷻ blesses with wealth who spends it in the way of Allaah ﷻ.

Aayah 15

Ajma'oo comes from *ijmaa'*, unanimous consensus, which means to agree on something. Allaah ﷻ does not give details of the event occurring here but some books of tafseer say that Yoosuf ﷺ approached them individually reminding them.

The brothers had to find a particular remote well in which to put Yoosuf ﷺ. This would allow him to survive in the desert since he would have access to a supply of water. It was a well that was large enough so that he would not drown in it nor would he be able to escape on his own. In the case that he was found or seen, it would not be by their townspeople. Lastly, the brothers did not want him dead, rather they wanted him far removed from their father in the hopes that Yoosuf ﷺ would eventually be forgotten.

While Yoosuf ﷺ was alone and scared in the well, Allaah ﷻ sent him waHee, or revelation, to comfort him. This does not necessitate Prophethood (e.g. the mother of Prophet Musa ﷺ was inspired, too, yet she is not a Prophetess). There are a few promises

embedded in this message. Since Allah ﷻ tells Yoosuf that he will later tell his brothers of what they did, this shows that he will not die from this ordeal. His brothers will not realize or recognize him shows that his status will be elevated well beyond theirs. Despite having committed such a crime against him, Yoosuf ﷺ will still wish to speak with them and bring their family back together.

Aayaat 16-18

Allaah ﷻ says:

وَجَاءُوا آبَاهُمْ عِشَاءً يَبْكُونَ قَالُوا ۖ يَا أَبَانَا إِنَّا ذَهَبْنَا نَسْتَبِقُ وَتَرَكْنَا يُوسُفَ
عِنْدَ مَتْعِنَا فَاكَلَهُ الذِّئْبُ ۖ وَمَا أَنْتَ بِمُؤْمِنٍ لَّنَا وَلَوْ كُنَّا صَادِقِينَ ۖ وَجَاءُوا
عَلَى قَمِيصِهِ بِدَمٍ كَذِبٍ ۚ قَالَ بَلْ سَوَّلَتْ لَكُمْ أَنْفُسُكُمْ أَمْرًا فَصَبْرٌ جَمِيلٌ ۖ وَاللَّهُ
الْمُسْتَعَانُ عَلَىٰ مَا تَصِفُونَ ۚ

16. And they came to their father at night, weeping. 17. They said, “O our father, indeed we went racing each other and left Joseph with our possessions, and a wolf ate him. But you would not believe us, even if we were truthful.”

18. And they brought upon his shirt false blood. [Jacob] said, “Rather, your souls have enticed you to something, so patience is most fitting. And Allaah is the one sought for help against that which you describe.”

[Soorat Yoosuf: 16-18]

Aayah 16

The brothers returned to their father at night when the horizon was no longer red, at ‘Isha time. They were well aware of their father’s acute sense of perception. They knew that, had they come sooner, their father would be able to detect their lies just from their faces. So they came altogether when it was dark crying their crocodile tears in an effort to show sincerity in what they were about to explain.

Aayah 17

The brothers used Ya'qoob's ﷺ fear of wolves as they narrate their story. They said they went racing, which tells us that it is permissible to race, even with your wife as the Prophet ﷺ did so with 'Aa'isha.

عَنْ عَائِشَةَ قَالَتْ خَرَجْتُ مَعَ النَّبِيِّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ فِي بَعْضِ أَسْفَارِهِ وَأَنَا جَارِيَةٌ لَمْ أَحْمِلِ اللَّحْمَ وَلَمْ أَبْدُنْ فَقَالَ لِلنَّاسِ تَقَدَّمُوا فَتَقَدَّمُوا ثُمَّ قَالَ لِي تَعَالَيْ حَتَّى أُسَابِقَكَ فَسَابَقْتُهُ فَسَبَقْتُهُ فَسَكَتَ عَنِّي حَتَّى إِذَا حَمَلْتُ اللَّحْمَ وَبَدُنْتُ وَنَسِيتُ خَرَجْتُ مَعَهُ فِي بَعْضِ أَسْفَارِهِ فَقَالَ لِلنَّاسِ تَقَدَّمُوا فَتَقَدَّمُوا ثُمَّ قَالَ تَعَالَيْ حَتَّى أُسَابِقَكَ فَسَابَقْتُهُ فَسَبَقَنِي فَجَعَلَ يَضْحَكُ وَهُوَ يَقُولُ هَذِهِ بِتِلْكَ

Aisha: "I went out with the Prophet on a journey. At that time I was a young girl and was quite slender. The Prophet told the people 'Go on ahead,' so they went ahead, then he said to me, 'Come, let us have a race.' So I raced with him, and I won. He let the matter rest until I had gained weight. Later, I accompanied him on another journey. He told the people, 'Go on ahead,' so they went ahead. He said to me, 'Come, and let us have a race.' So I raced with him, and he won. He began to laugh, and said, 'This is for that.'"

[Ahmad]

Competition is good except when it incites negativity. It is good when no reward is being given for it rewards may cause people to have negative thoughts about one another.

(قال النبي صلى الله عليه وسلم : (لَا سَبَقَ إِلَّا فِي نَصْلِ أَوْ خُفٍّ أَوْ حَافِرٍ

[الترمذي والنسائي وأبو داود وابن ماجه]

The Prophet (peace and blessings of Allaah be upon him) said: "There should be no (money) prizes for competitions except in archery, camel-racing and horse-racing."

[At-Tirmidhi, al-Nasaa'i, Abu Dawood and Ibn Majaah]

Some of the scholars have said rewards are permissible if it is to advance knowledge because that is also a type of jihaad. However, there should not be any reward when people are

competing to recite the Qur'aan. When people compete in Qur'aan competitions they might be happy when someone makes a mistake; that is not acceptable in Islam. Another issue that arises with Qur'aan competitions is that sometimes when a person loses he/she may get so disheartened that he/she does not want to read the Qur'aan anymore.

The brothers said they left Yoosuf عليه السلام with their possessions as they raced and a wolf ate him. They then said, you know we're lying but you wouldn't believe us even if we were truthful. If a person lies, another lie will come out of it.

Aayah 18

The brothers committed a crime. No one commits a perfect crime; people will always forget something and there are always clues left behind because there are so many variables. Usually if a person lies, he/she will have to lie even more to cover it up. In Islaam you are allowed to ask questions to get the truth out but no torture is allowed.

"The Prophet ﷺ sent three emigrant leaders, Ali Ibn Abi Talib, az-Zubari Ibn al-Awam and Sa'd Ibn Abi Waqqas to inquire about the location of the enemies. Two men were seen drawing water from the wells of Badr. Upon question, they admitted that they were carrying water for the Makkan army. But some Companions were not pleased with this answer, since they thought that the boys belonged to Abu Sufyan. So they beat the two boys, who finally said that they belonged to Abu Sufyan. When Allah's Messenger ﷺ was informed, he said angrily, "on telling the truth, you beat them, and on lying you released them!" Then he ﷺ himself spoke to the two boys, who informed him about the army's location, leaders and that they were so huge that they slaughter ten camels everyday to feed their men. The Prophet ﷺ then turned towards the Muslims and said: "The Quraysh has sent you their most precious lives."

[The Sealed Nectar]

The brothers brought a shirt to their father. Some scholars say they slaughtered a lamb and drenched Yoosuf's عليه السلام shirt with its blood. Immediately when Ya'qoob عليه السلام saw the shirt he knew they were lying as it was still intact, there were no tear marks. Furthermore, why

would they bring the shirt back? In Shari'ah you can use clues to help you uncover the truth (e.g. modern technology like the use DNA testing is permissible). Then Ya'qoob عليه السلام tells them they were lying but as for himself he will have a "beautiful patience." Beautiful patience is when you are patient from the very beginning of a difficult situation.

Reflections

Patience is needed at the onset of problems, when the issue first strikes.

مَرَّ النَّبِيُّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ بِامْرَأَةٍ تَبْكِي عِنْدَ قَبْرِ فَقَالَ اتَّقِي اللَّهَ وَاصْبِرِي قَالَتْ إِلَيْكَ عَنِّي فَإِنَّكَ لَمْ تُصَبِّ بِمُصِيبَتِي وَلَمْ تَعْرِفْهُ فَقِيلَ لَهَا إِنَّهُ النَّبِيُّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ فَأَتَتْ بَابَ النَّبِيِّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ فَلَمْ تَجِدْ عِنْدَهُ بَوَائِينَ فَقَالَتْ لَمْ أَعْرِفْكَ فَقَالَ إِنَّمَا الصَّبْرُ عِنْدَ الصَّدْمَةِ الْأُولَى

Narrated Anas bin Malik: The Prophet passed by a woman who was weeping beside a grave. He told her to fear Allah and be patient. She said to him, "Go away, for you have not been afflicted with a calamity like mine." And she did not recognize him.

Then she was informed that he was the Prophet. so she went to the house of the Prophet and there she did not find any guard. Then she said to him, "I did not recognize you." He said, "Verily, the patience is at the first stroke of a calamity."

[Bukhari]

If someone is jealous about another person having a Lamborghini, this may seem like a big deal to the person at the moment. However, take the example of a child not having the opportunity to play with something and the way he overreacts might be worse than when someone passes away!

As adults, we may think this is a minor issue but to the child it is a huge deal! Allaah سُبْحَانَهُ may be looking at us the way we look at this child making such a fuss about something so small.

Take the example of a man who entered the masjid with his two children. The children began running around playing tag while you try to pray. The father sits there allowing his children to run around and you allow this circumstance ruin your khushoo'. Eventually you try to speak to the brother about the children's behavior. He apologizes saying that his wife, their mother, had just passed away and he does not know how to break it to them. Just a moment ago you were angry, infuriated, and at the mention of this you became soft and full of pity for those children who no longer have their mother.

Beautiful patience comes from Allaah سُبْحَانَهُ. To increase in this beautiful quality, think of the Hereafter, look at the bigger picture, and it will help you to be patient.



Chapter 6

**The Conflict:
Al-Azeez and His Wife**

Chapter 6: The Conflict: Yusuf, Al-Axeex and His Wife

Aayaat 19-20

Allaah ﷻ says:

وَجَاءَتْ سَيَّارَةٌ فَأَرْسَلُوا وَارِدَهُمْ فَأَدْلَى دَلْوَهُ قَالَ يَبُشْرَىٰ هَذَا غُلَامٌ وَأَسَرُّهُ بِضْعَةً
وَاللَّهُ عَلِيمٌ بِمَا يَعْمَلُونَ ﴿١٩﴾ وَشَرَوْهُ بِثَمَنٍ بَخْسٍ دَرَاهِمَ مَعْدُودَةٍ وَكَانُوا فِيهِ مِنَ
الزَّاهِدِينَ ﴿٢٠﴾

19. And there came a company of travelers; then they sent their water drawer, and he let down his bucket. He said, "Good news! Here is a boy." And they concealed him, [taking him] as merchandise; and Allaah was knowing of what they did. 20. And they sold him for a reduced price - a few dirhams - and they were, concerning him, of those content with little.

[Soorat Yusuf 12: 19-20]

Some scholars mention that Yusuf ﷺ was in the well for three days and others say that he was there far more than that. We do not have information on how many days he really was there as there are no real authentic hadeeth specifying the amount of time spent.

The water drawer of a passing caravan found Yusuf ﷺ and he hid him as merchandise. This person who is pulling up the bucket with the boy must be strong, especially because of what his job entails. This person says "Good news!" because he now had a boy he could sell as a slave in Egypt. And so he hides young Yusuf ﷺ amongst the merchandise.

Why does he hide him? This water drawer most likely was not in charge of the caravan; he was probably someone who had been hired by the caravan leader. If the leader found out about the boy, he would be likely to take Yusuf ﷺ from the water drawer and claim him under his

own merchandise.

These people were not caring people; they only wanted to make the best profit because at this time the slave trade in Egypt was alive & well and the price for a *young male* slave was very high. As a result, we do not see them care about where this boy came from or even, how he came to be in a well. As we see later on in history, this was all part of Allaah's ﷻ plan for Yusuf ﷻ & Banu Israaeel.

At this time, Banu Israaeel, the children of Ya'qoub ﷻ, were living in Kan'aan or Canaan in Ash-Shaam, modern day Palestine. And we know that later on, Musa ﷻ was sent to Banu Israaeel in Egypt; What would cause them to move from the Holy Land of Ash-Shaam to the deserts of Egypt?

The answer is Yusuf ﷻ. His travel to Egypt was the reason for the migration of Banu Israaeel to Egypt & then back again from Egypt with Musa ﷻ & then 'Issa ﷻ was sent to them in Ash-Shaam where he told them of the coming of the final Prophet to Mankind, Muhammad ﷺ. This story set the stage for the later historical accounts in the Qur'aan.

And what about Yusuf's ﷻ brothers? Scholars say there are a couple of possibilities. One of the weaker ones states that Yusuf ﷻ was left in the well and the next day the brothers came back and took him out just to make sure that he would be sold. They then saw the people of the caravan & sold him to them but this does not explain why he was hidden amongst the merchandise and Allaah ﷻ knows best.

He ﷻ was sold into slavery; and in Islaam it is a sin to sell anyone as a slave **unless** they are prisoners of war. These people are distributed amongst the fighters but even then, slavery in Islam states that they should have equal to what their owners have (i.e. your slave eats what you eat, dresses the way you dress, etc.) You are responsible for them financially. They are not mere playthings for you to abuse & use & all those other connotations modern slavery has connected to it.

As for why he ﷻ was sold for such a low price, one opinion states that his brothers were the ones who sold him & did not care about the price because he was insignificant to them. Another says he was sold for a very low price because the water drawer & his accomplices didn't value him much since they received him for free. Another opinion is that they sold him quickly because they didn't want the caravan leader or anyone else to find out.

Aayaat 21-29

Allaah ﷻ says:

وَقَالَ الَّذِي اشْتَرَاهُ مِنْ مِصْرَ لَا مِرَاتٍ أَكْرِمِي مَثْوَاهُ عَسَىٰ أَنْ يَنْفَعَنَا أَوْ نَتَّخِذَهُ وَلَدًا
وَكَذَٰلِكَ مَكَّنَّا لِيُوسُفَ فِي الْأَرْضِ وَلِنُعَلِّمَهُ مِنْ تَأْوِيلِ الْأَحَادِيثِ وَاللَّهُ غَالِبٌ عَلَىٰ
أَمْرِهِ وَلَٰكِنَّ أَكْثَرَ النَّاسِ لَا يَعْلَمُونَ ﴿٢١﴾ وَلَمَّا بَلَغَ أَشُدَّهُ رَءَاهُ آتَيْنَاهُ حُكْمًا وَعِلْمًا
وَكَذَٰلِكَ نَجْزِي الْمُحْسِنِينَ ﴿٢٢﴾ وَرَاودَتْهُ أَلَّتِي هُوَ فِي بَيْتِهَا عَنْ نَفْسِهِ وَغَلَّقَتِ
الْأَبْوَابَ وَقَالَتْ هَيْتَ لَكَ قَالَ مَعَاذَ اللَّهِ إِنَّهُ رَبِّي أَحْسَنَ مَثْوَايَ إِنَّهُ لَا يُفْلِحُ
الظَّالِمُونَ ﴿٢٣﴾ وَلَقَدْ هَمَّتْ بِهِ وَهَمَّ بِهَا لَوْلَا أَنْ رَأَاهُ بُرْهَنَ رَبِّهِ كَذَٰلِكَ
لِنَصْرِفَ عَنْهُ السُّوءَ وَالْفَحْشَاءَ إِنَّهُ مِنْ عِبَادِنَا الْمُخْلَصِينَ ﴿٢٤﴾ وَاسْتَبَقَا الْبَابَ
وَقَدَّتْ قَمِيصَهُ مِنْ دُبُرٍ وَأَلْفَيَا سَيِّدَهَا لَدَا الْبَابِ قَالَتْ مَا جَزَاءُ مَنْ أَرَادَ بِأَهْلِكَ سُوءًا
إِلَّا أَنْ يُسْجَنَ أَوْ عَذَابٌ أَلِيمٌ ﴿٢٥﴾ قَالَ هِيَ رَاودَتْنِي عَنْ نَفْسِي وَشَهِدَ شَاهِدٌ مِّنْ
أَهْلِهَا إِنْ كَانَ قَمِيصُهُ قُدَّ مِنْ قُبُلٍ فَصَدَقَتْ وَهُوَ مِنَ الْكَاذِبِينَ ﴿٢٦﴾ وَإِنْ كَانَ
قَمِيصُهُ قُدَّ مِنْ دُبُرٍ فَكَذَبَتْ وَهُوَ مِنَ الصَّادِقِينَ ﴿٢٧﴾ فَلَمَّا رَأَاهُ قَمِيصُهُ قُدَّ مِنْ دُبُرٍ
قَالَ إِنَّهُ مِنْ كَيْدِكُنَّ إِنَّ كَيْدَكُنَّ عَظِيمٌ ﴿٢٨﴾ يُوسُفُ أَعْرِضْ عَنْ هَٰذَا وَاسْتَغْفِرِي
لِذُنُوبِكِ إِنَّكَ كُنتِ مِنَ الْخَاطِئِينَ ﴿٢٩﴾

21. And the one from Egypt who bought him said to his wife, "Make his residence comfortable. Perhaps he will benefit us, or we will adopt him as a

son." And thus, We established Joseph in the land that We might teach him the interpretation of events. And Allaah is predominant over His affair, but most of the people do not know. 22. And when Joseph reached maturity, We gave him judgment and knowledge. And thus We reward the doers of good. 23. And she, in whose house he was, sought to seduce him. She closed the doors and said, "Come, you." He said, "[I seek] the refuge of Allaah. Indeed, he is my master, who has made good my residence. Indeed, wrongdoers will not succeed." 24. And she certainly determined [to seduce] him, and he would have inclined to her had he not seen the proof of his Lord. And thus [it was] that We should avert from him evil and immorality. Indeed, he was of Our chosen servants. 25. And they both raced to the door, and she tore his shirt from the back, and they found her husband at the door. She said, "What is the recompense of one who intended evil for your wife but that he be imprisoned or a painful punishment?" 26. [Joseph] said, "It was she who sought to seduce me." And a witness testified. "If his shirt is torn from the front, then she has told the truth, and he is of the liars. 27. But if his shirt is torn from the back, then she has lied, and he is of the truthful." 28. So when her husband saw his shirt torn from the back, he said, "Indeed, it is of the women's plan. Indeed, your plan is great. 29. Joseph, ignore this. And, [my wife], ask forgiveness for your sin. Indeed, you were of the sinful."

[Soorat Yusuf: 21-29]

Aayah 21

Yusuf عليه السلام was brought to Egypt from Jerusalem. This indicates that this caravan went back and forth between Egypt and that area regularly. In Egypt, he was bought by Al-‘Azeez, the minister of finance, a rich noble in the society named. We do not know Al-‘Azeez’s real name.

Al-‘Azeez told his wife to be hospitable to Yusuf عليه السلام in the hopes that the young boy could benefit them through his strength. He even suggests adopting Yusuf عليه السلام as a son.

“Interpretation of events” can mean interpreting dreams or the understanding of the Book to interpret it and call people to that message. Yusuf عليه السلام spent his childhood in Egypt serving the minister. This is how Allaah سبحانه established Yusuf عليه السلام to take his position and have his status to be raised.

Aayah 22

Ihsaan has been defined as worshipping Allaah ﷻ as if you see him and if you cannot see Him, then know that He sees you. This is how we are to supposed to worship Him ﷻ.

Yusuf ﷺ had aged both physically and mentally & had reached manhood. Allaah ﷻ says We gave him wisdom and knowledge.

The Prophet ﷺ said,

مَنْ يُرِدِ اللَّهُ بِهِ خَيْرًا يُفَقِّهْهُ فِي الدِّينِ

“He who Allaah wants good for, He gives him understanding of the deen (religion).”

[Bukhari]

When Allaah ﷻ gives you knowledge, it is an indication that He ﷻ loves you.

At the same time, we also need to have fear of Allaah ﷻ as having hope & fear of Allaah ﷻ is the definition of Taqwa. Yusuf ﷺ had both so we see here the care Allaah ﷻ had for him.

Aayah 23

As we mentioned before, Yusuf ﷺ was very handsome. The Prophet ﷺ said in a hadeeth,

فَإِذَا أَنَا بِيُوسُفَ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ إِذَا هُوَ قَدْ أُعْطِيَ شَطْرَ الْحُسْنِ

“When I met Yusuf ﷺ, I saw that Allaah ﷻ has blessed him with half of the beauty of the whole world, while the other half has been spread over the rest of it”

[Muslim]

And, as expected, the wife of Al-‘Azeez was filled with lust for Yusuf ﷺ. It got to the point, where she couldn’t stop herself from feeling so strongly towards him because he was so beautiful.

So she prepared herself for him and locked all the doors. The word غَلَقَتْ does not only mean “to lock” but “to lock **very tightly** & with **absolute** certainty.” From this, we can understand that the wife of Al-‘Azeez closed not only the door to the room she & Yusuf ﴿ٱلْعَلِيَّةُ﴾ were in but **all** the doors to the house and *any other* doors leading to those doors so that nothing would interrupt what she intended to do. And then she called for Yusuf ﴿ٱلْعَلِيَّةُ﴾ to come to her.

Yusuf ﴿ٱلْعَلِيَّةُ﴾ refused and said he could not do this to his master. By this, some scholars say that Yusuf ﴿ٱلْعَلِيَّةُ﴾ here was reminding her that Al-‘Azeez had been very kind all this time and Yusuf ﴿ٱلْعَلِيَّةُ﴾ did not intend to do anything to harm him.

Another opinion said by scholars is that Prophet Yusuf ﴿ٱلْعَلِيَّةُ﴾ here is referring to Allaah ﴿ٱللَّهُ﴾ who took care of him and that he would not commit such a great sin. This second opinion is stronger since Allaah ﴿ٱللَّهُ﴾ is mentioned in the next aayah.

Aayah 24

What “proof” is this aayah referring to? Some scholars say that he saw the angel Jibreel ﴿ٱلْجِبْرِيلُ﴾. Others say he saw an image of his father. The stronger opinion states that the “proof” was him realizing or Allaah ﴿ٱللَّهُ﴾ reminding him of his position and status as a Prophet and messenger. Just the knowledge of that kept Yusuf ﴿ٱلْعَلِيَّةُ﴾ away.

Abu Hurairah ﴿ٱلْحُرَيْرَةُ﴾ narrated that Rasul Allaah ﴿ٱللَّهُ﴾ said,

سَبْعَةٌ يُظِلُّهُمْ ٱللَّهُ تَعَالَىٰ فِي ظِلِّهِ يَوْمَ لَا ظِلَّ إِلَّا ظِلُّهُ: إِمَامٌ عَدْلٌ، وَشَابٌّ نَشَأَ فِي عِبَادَةِ ٱللَّهِ، وَرَجُلٌ قَلْبُهُ مُعَلَّقٌ فِي ٱلْمَسَاجِدِ، وَرَجُلَانِ تَحَابَّا فِي ٱللَّهِ اجْتَمَعَا عَلَيْهِ وَتَفَرَّقَا عَلَيْهِ، وَرَجُلٌ دَعَتْهُ أَمْرَأَةٌ ذَاتُ مَنْصِبٍ وَجَمَالٍ فَقَالَ إِنِّي أَخَافُ ٱللَّهِ، وَرَجُلٌ تَصَدَّقَ بِصَدَقَةٍ فَأَخْفَاهَا حَتَّىٰ لَا تَعْلَمَ شِمَالُهُ مَا تُنْفِقُ يَمِينُهُ، وَرَجُلٌ ذَكَرَ ٱللَّهَ خَالِيًا فَفَاضَتْ عَيْنَاهُ

"Seven people will be shaded by Allaah under His shade on the day when there will be no shade except His. They are a just ruler; a young man who has been brought up in the worship of Allaah, (i.e. worship Allaah (Alone) sincerely from his childhood); a man whose heart is attached to the mosque (who offers the five compulsory congregational prayers in the mosque); two persons who love each other only for Allaah's sake and they meet and part in Allaah's cause only; a man who refuses the call of a charming woman of noble birth for an illegal sexual intercourse with her and says: I am afraid of Allaah; a person who practices charity so secretly that his left

hand does not know what his right hand has given (i.e. nobody knows how much he has given in charity); a person who remembers Allaah in seclusion and his eyes get flooded with tears." (emphasis added)

[Bukhari]

All of the actions mentioned are continuous actions except for the one underlined above. This describes **one** instance where a decision must be *quickly* made so in comparison to the other actions it is seemingly insignificant; yet this is how much of a reward one gets for abstaining. It makes them equal to those who do the other actions throughout their lives! Yusuf ﷺ exemplified this deed and so Allaah ﷻ helped him control his desires.

Aayah 25

They both raced towards the door with different intentions; he raced to escape and she raced to make sure he didn't. This shows Yusuf's ﷺ nobility because he could've harmed her to avoid her, but instead he tried to escape. Her behavior shows the dangers of her love, passion and lust. There are so many people who do such things and we cannot imagine how they could bring themselves to commit a certain action. These people in reality are just so blinded by love and lust that, as we said before, they become irrational.

As he was trying to get away, she grabbed Yusuf's ﷺ shirt and it tore from the back and then they find Al-'Azeez at the door. We can assume that normally Al-'Azeez is not usually home during that time because we know all the precautions his wife took when she planned to seduce Yusuf ﷺ. She is so surprised that she immediately tries to prevent herself from being blamed. She says, "What is the punishment for someone who wants to do lewd acts to your wife, but be imprisoned or painful punishment". She claims that Yusuf ﷺ was responsible for the scene her husband saw in front of him. She also mentions the punishment that should befall Yusuf ﷺ for taking advantage of her; imprisonment or painful torture.

Aayah 26

Immediately, Prophet Yusuf ﷺ defended his reputation by saying she was the one who seduced him. And then there was a witness who some say may have been from her own family though if they had been, they would have been more likely to protect her than Yusuf ﷺ. There are some narrations about a baby being there who spoke but those are weak narrations. The strongest narrations are that it was somebody who knew about her strong feelings towards

Prophet Yusuf عليه السلام. The witness said, if his shirt was torn from the front then she is truthful and he is among the liars.

Aayaat 27-28

And if his shirt was torn from the front, it would have shown that she tried to fight him off as he advanced on her. If his shirt was torn from the back, it would have shown that he tried to get away from her but she held onto him. So when her husband saw his shirt torn from the back, he said indeed the plot of you women is mighty and great.

Aayah 29

When a mistake is done for the first time, you should take precautionary measures so that it is not repeated. You are supposed to learn from your mistake the first time you make it. The exact reason behind Al-'Azeez's lack of action remains unknown but some reasons as to why he did not do anything about the situation include not wanting to make it a big deal or to save some embarrassment for his wife. Maybe he did not want his reputation to be tainted as it would have been if people found out and Allaah ﷻ knows best. Al-'Azeez told Yusuf عليه السلام to brush this matter aside and he turned to his wife and said you seek forgiveness for your sin. Some narrations say he meant to ask for forgiveness from Yusuf عليه السلام and him, and other narrations say he meant for her to ask Allaah ﷻ for forgiveness. And he continued by saying indeed you are amongst the sinful.

Aayaat 30-35

Allaah ﷻ says:

﴿ وَقَالَ نِسْوَةٌ فِي الْمَدِينَةِ امْرَأَتُ الْعَزِيزِ تُرَاوِدُ فَتَاهَا عَنْ نَفْسِهِ ۖ قَدْ شَغَفَهَا حُبًّا إِنَّا لَنَرُلَهَا فِي ضَلَالٍ مُّبِينٍ ۝ فَامَّا سَمِعَتْ بِمَكْرِهِنَّ أَرْسَلَتْ إِلَيْهِنَّ وَأَعْتَدَتْ لَهُنَّ مُتَكًا ۖ وَآتَتْ كُلَّ وَاحِدَةٍ مِّنْهُنَّ سِكِّينًا ۖ وَقَالَتِ اخْرُجْ عَلَيْهِنَّ ۖ فَلَمَّا رَأَيْنَهُ أَكْبَرْنَهُ ۖ وَقَطَّعْنَ أَيْدِيَهُنَّ وَقُلْنَ حَاشَ لِلَّهِ مَا هَذَا بَشَرًا إِن هَذَا إِلَّا مَلَكٌ كَرِيمٌ ۝ قَالَتْ فَذَلِكُنَّ الَّذِي لُمْتُنَّنِي فِيهِ ۖ وَلَقَدْ رَاودْتُهُ ۖ عَنْ نَفْسِهِ ۖ فَاسْتَعْصَمَ ۖ وَلَئِن لَّمْ يَفْعَلْ مَا ءَامُرُهُ لَيُسْجَنَنَّ وَلَيَكُونَا مِنَ الصَّغِيرِينَ ۝ قَالَ رَبِّ السِّجْنُ أَحَبُّ إِلَيَّ مِمَّا يَدْعُونَنِي إِلَيْهِ ۖ وَإِلَّا تَصْرِفْ عَنِّي كَيْدَهُنَّ أَصْبُ إِلَيْهِنَّ وَأَكُن مِّنَ الْجَاهِلِينَ ۝ فَاسْتَجَابَ لَهُ رَبُّهُ ۖ فَصَرَفَ عَنْهُ كَيْدَهُنَّ ۚ إِنَّهُ هُوَ السَّمِيعُ الْعَلِيمُ ۝ ثُمَّ بَدَأَ لَهُمْ مِّنْ بَعْدِ مَا رَأَوُا الْأَيَّاتِ لَيَسْجُنَّهُ ۖ حَتَّىٰ حِينٍ ۝ ﴾



30. And women in the city said, "The wife of al-'Azeez is seeking to seduce her slave boy; he has impassioned her with love. Indeed, we see her [to be] in clear error." 31. So when she heard of their scheming, she sent for them and prepared for them a banquet and gave each one of them a knife and said [to Joseph], "Come out before them." And when they saw him, they greatly admired him and cut their hands and said, "Perfect is Allaah ! This is not a man; this is none but a noble angel." 32. She said, "That is the one about whom you blamed me. And I certainly sought to seduce him, but he firmly refused; and if he will not do what I order him, he will surely be imprisoned and will be of those debased. 33. He said, "My Lord, prison is more to my liking than that to which they invite me. And if You do not avert from me their plan, I might incline toward them and [thus] be of the ignorant." 34. So his Lord responded to him and averted from him their plan. Indeed, He is the Hearing,

the Knowing. 35. Then it appeared to them after they had seen the signs that Al-'Azeez should surely imprison him for a time.

[Soorat Yusuf: 30 -35]

Aayah 30

The women in the city started to gossip about the incident after it occurred but they made it worse by making it seem as if the wife of Al-'Azeez was *continuously* trying to seduce her slave. They also did not use her name or Yusuf's ﷺ name but instead referred to them as "the wife of Al-'Azeez" "her slave." Speaking like this uses their statuses and causes the situation to sound a lot worse than it actually is. This is why it is not permissible to gossip even if it is truthful.

Imam Muhammad bin Ishaq bin Yasar narrated,

قَالَ الْإِمَامُ مُحَمَّدُ بْنُ إِسْحَاقَ بْنِ يَسَارٍ أَنَّ أَبَا أَيُّوبَ خَالِدَ بْنَ زَيْدٍ قَالَتْ لَهُ امْرَأَتُهُ أُمُّ أَيُّوبَ : يَا أَبَا أَيُّوبَ ،
أَمَا تَسْمَعُ مَا يَقُولُ النَّاسُ فِي عَائِشَةَ ، رَضِيَ اللَّهُ عَنْهَا؟ قَالَ : نَعَمْ ، وَذَلِكَ الْكَذِبُ . أَكُنْتُ فَاعِلَةً ذَلِكَ
يَا أُمُّ أَيُّوبَ؟ قَالَتْ : لَا وَاللَّهِ مَا كُنْتُ لِأَفْعَلَهُ . قَالَ : فَعَائِشَةُ وَاللَّهِ خَيْرٌ مِنْكَ

"The wife of Abu Ayyub Khalid bin Zayd Al-Ansari, Umm Ayyub, said to him, 'O Abu Ayyub, have you heard what the people are saying about 'A'ishah' He said, 'Yes, and it is all lies. Would you do that, O Umm Ayyub' She said, 'No, by Allaah, I would not do that.' He said, 'And by Allaah, 'A'ishah is better than you.'

Gossiping, slandering, and backbiting are **major** sins. If you have an issue with someone or hear something about someone, you should go to that person directly and handle what you need to handle. Do not indulge in or allow the spread of a rumor to continue. We should always defend the honor of Muslim brothers and sisters.

The women are saying that she is *passionately* in love with him and that her heart is **drowned** with this passion. They are saying all this because they themselves also have a plot; to see this slave that has caused all this.

Aayah 31

The wife of Al-'Azeez understood that they were saying all this because they wanted to see Yusuf ﷺ. They wanted to see what would cause the wife of a noble minister to risk losing everything for. So she arranges a banquet for all of them to see Yusuf ﷺ and she hands each of them a knife, knowing that his beauty would distract them from whatever they were cutting. She tells Yusuf ﷺ to come out and when he does, the women are in such awe

from his beauty that they all cut their own hands instead of the fruits they were given. They refused to believe that he was a man. He had to be an otherworldly creature. He had to be an angel.

Aayah 32

The wife finally had their sympathy. She asked them whether they still blamed her for trying to seduce him. They had only seen him for a brief moment of time and were cutting their hands; could they imagine being in her position where she was around him every day? She admitted that she tried to seduce him and he refused but she would now order him to do as she wished or else he would face a punishment/ imprison him.

Aayah 33

This is arguably one of the most powerful *aayah* in this Surah. Prophet Yusuf عليه السلام says that he would rather suffer in prison than to fall for what they invited him to do (i.e. intercourse.)

Why would he make such a drastic statement? Because he عليه السلام knew that the true prison is the prison of the hereafter and that nothing in this world could compare to the punishment of the next. RasulAllaah ﷺ said,

الدُّنْيَا سِجْنُ الْمُؤْمِنِ وَجَنَّةُ الْكَافِرِ

“Verily, the worldly life is a prison for the believers and a paradise for the disbelievers.”

[Muslim]

This means that in comparison to the rewards the believers are going to get in the hereafter, this life is like a prison and in comparison to the punishments in store for the disbelievers, this life is paradise.

Prophet Yusuf عليه السلام is exemplifying patience in these aayaat.

- (a) He shows patience in the obedience of Allaah ﷻ
- (b) Patience in avoiding that which is haaram
- (c) Patience when calamity befalls you

At the time, he was the **only** Muslim in Egypt. He was living amongst non-Muslims in Egypt and not just non-Muslims but idol worshippers. And even in a society so far removed from his own surrounded by a culture so different from his own and in the midst of people with different beliefs than his own, he stayed true to his deen and his Lord. This is determination and patience.

Prophet Yusuf عليه السلام set an example for us that in times of hardship, we need to turn to Allaah ﷻ. Any time a person gives up something for the sake of Allaah ﷻ, then Allaah ﷻ will give him or her something better.

RasulAllaah ﷺ went through a great deal of difficulty after he lost his beloved uncle, Abu Talib and soon after he dealt with the death of his wife, Khadija رضي الله عنها. He ﷺ had also been preaching Islam for almost a decade and the Quraish had yet to lessen their attacks on him and his followers. At the same time, they continued to try to discredit him ﷺ and his message.

When this surah was revealed, it provided many lessons of patience for RasulAllaah ﷺ and the believers. It helped them stay focused on what mattered and it showed them to be thankful to Allaah ﷻ because while they had each other, Yusuf عليه السلام was all alone.

In this particular aayah, we see that things seem to have gotten worse for Yusuf عليه السلام. Now, it was not only one woman he had to be careful of anymore but **all** the powerful women of the entire city that were plotting against him.

He عليه السلام is saying that if Allaah ﷻ was not to protect him from their plots, then he would fall to them like any other man would have.

Aayah 34

Allaah ﷻ responded to his prayers, and turned away their plot. When sin is in front of you, stop and remember Allaah ﷻ because when you remember Allaah ﷻ, it makes it so much harder for Shaytaan to continue leading you into that sin. In fact Shaytaan runs away.

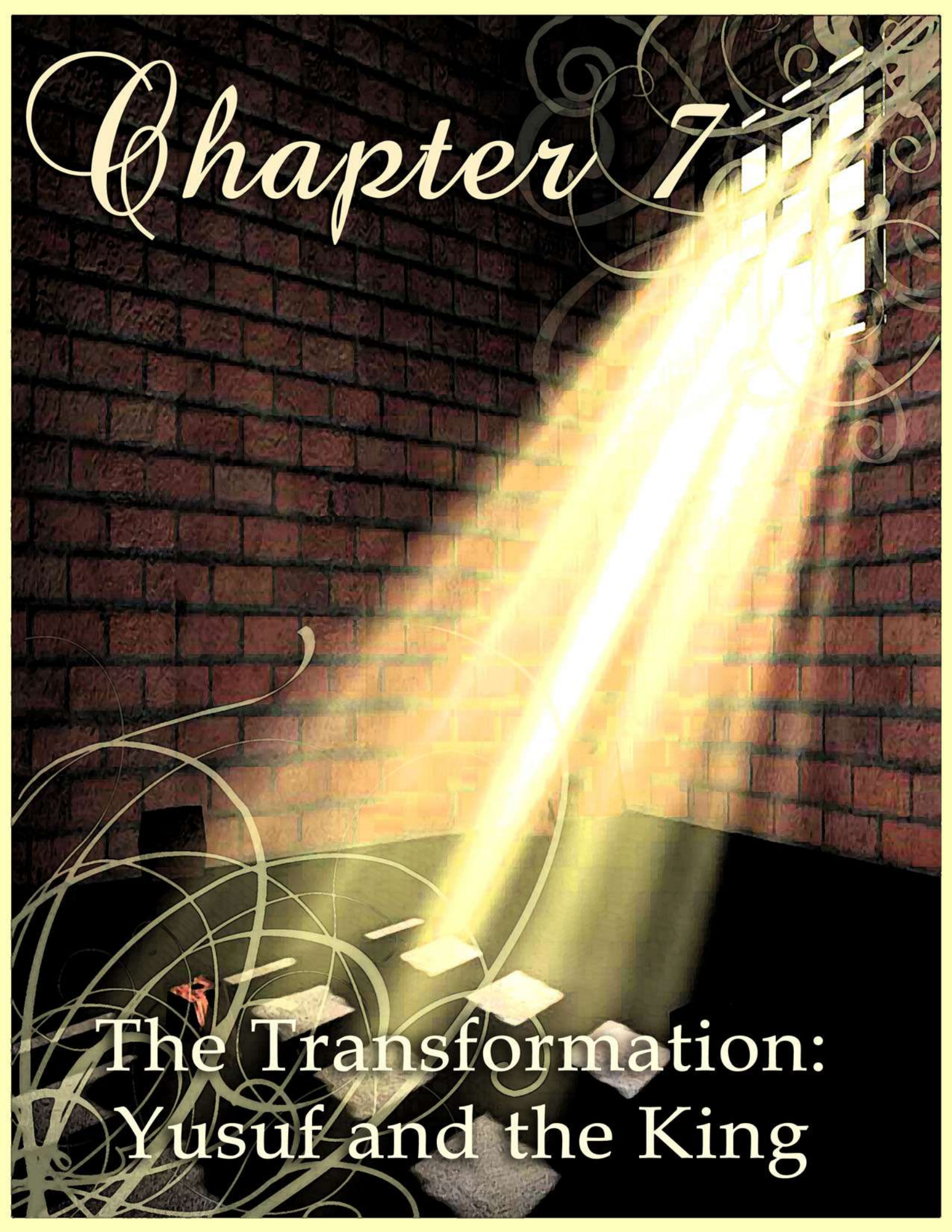
Aayah 35

And so Yusuf عليه السلام was wrongly imprisoned for a prescribed period of time.

Reflections

- 1) We should choose the Creator over creations
- 2) We should choose everlasting joy over temporary enjoyment
- 3) We should flee to Allaah ﷻ at times of weaknesses

Chapter 7

The background of the entire page is a dramatic illustration. It shows a dark, textured brick wall. A powerful, bright yellow and orange light beam shines from a rectangular opening in the upper right corner of the wall. The light beam tapers as it descends, illuminating a dark, shadowed area below. In this dark area, there is a pile of debris, including what looks like a broken piece of wood or a small fire. The overall mood is one of hope or divine intervention.

The Transformation:
Yusuf and the King

Chapter 7: The Transformation: Yoosuf and the King

Aayaat 36-42

Allaah ﷻ says:

وَدَخَلَ مَعَهُ السِّجْنَ فَتَيَانِ قَالَ أَحَدُهُمَا إِنِّي أَرْنِي آعْصِرُ خَمْراً وَقَالَ الْآخَرُ إِنِّي أَرْنِي
أَحْمِلُ فَوْقَ رَأْسِي خُبْزاً تَأْكُلُ الطَّيْرُ مِنْهُ نَبِّئْنَا بِتَأْوِيلِهِ إِنَّا نَرَاكَ مِنَ الْمُحْسِنِينَ ﴿٣٦﴾
قَالَ لَا يَأْتِيكُمَا طَعَامٌ تُرْزَقَانِهِ إِلَّا نَبَّأْتُكُمَا بِتَأْوِيلِهِ قَبْلَ أَنْ يَأْتِيَكُمَا ذَلِكَمَا مِمَّا
عَلَّمَني رَبِّي إِنِّي تَرَكْتُ مِلَّةَ قَوْمٍ لَا يُؤْمِنُونَ بِاللَّهِ وَهُمْ بِالْآخِرَةِ هُمْ كَافِرُونَ ﴿٣٧﴾ وَاتَّبَعْتُ
مِلَّةَ آبَائِي إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَإِسْحَاقَ وَيَعْقُوبَ مَا كَانُوا لَنَا أَنْ نُشْرِكَ بِاللَّهِ مِنْ شَيْءٍ ذَلِكَ
مِنْ فَضْلِ اللَّهِ عَلَيْنَا وَعَلَى النَّاسِ وَلَكِنَّ أَكْثَرَ النَّاسِ لَا يَشْكُرُونَ ﴿٣٨﴾ يَصْحَبِي
السِّجْنِ رَبَّابٌ مُتَفَرِّقُونَ خَيْرٌ أَمِ اللَّهُ الْوَاحِدُ الْقَهَّارُ ﴿٣٩﴾ مَا تَعْبُدُونَ مِنْ دُونِهِ
إِلَّا أَسمَاءٌ سَمَّيْتُمُوهَا أَنْتُمْ وَآبَاؤُكُمْ مَا أَنْزَلَ اللَّهُ بِهَا مِنْ سُلْطَانٍ إِنْ الْحُكْمُ إِلَّا لِلَّهِ
أَمْرًا أَلَّا تَعْبُدُوا إِلَّا إِيَّاهُ ذَلِكَ الدِّينُ الْقَيِّمُ وَلَكِنَّ أَكْثَرَ النَّاسِ لَا يَعْلَمُونَ ﴿٤٠﴾
يَصْحَبِي السِّجْنِ أَمَّا أَحَدُكُمَا فَيَسْقِي رَبُّهُ خَمْراً وَأَمَّا الْآخَرُ فَيُصْلَبُ فَتَأْكُلُ
الطَّيْرُ مِنْ رَأْسِهِ قُضِيَ الْأَمْرُ الَّذِي فِيهِ تَسْتَفْتِيَانِ ﴿٤١﴾ وَقَالَ لِلَّذِي ظَنَّ أَنَّهُ نَاجٍ

مِنْهُمَا أَذْكُرْنِي عِنْدَ رَبِّكَ فَأَنْسَاهُ الشَّيْطَانُ ذِكْرَ رَبِّهِ فَلَبِثَ فِي السِّجْنِ بِضْعَ



36. And there entered with Him two young men in the prison. One of them said: "Verily, I saw myself (in a dream) pressing wine." the other said: "Verily, I saw myself (in a dream) carrying bread on my head and birds were eating thereof." (They said): "Inform us of the interpretation of this. Verily, we think you are one of the Muhsinoon (doers of good - see V.2:112)." 37. He said: "No food will come to you (in wakefulness or in dream) as Your provision, but I will Inform (in wakefulness) its interpretation before it (the food) comes. This is of that which My Lord has taught Me. Verily, I have abandoned the Religion of a people that believe not In Allaah and are disbelievers In the Hereafter (i.e. the Kan'ânioon of Egypt who were polytheists and used to Worship sun and other false deities). 38. "And I have followed the religion of my fathers , - Ibraheem (Abraham), Ishaq (Isaac) and Ya'qoob (Jacob), and never could we attribute any partners whatsoever to Allaah. This is from the Grace of Allaah to us and to mankind, but Most men thank not (i.e. they neither believe In Allaah, nor Worship Him). 39. "O two companions of the prison! Are many different lords (gods) better or Allaah, the one, the Irresistible? 40. "You do not Worship besides Him but only names which you have named (forged), you and your fathers, for which Allaah has sent down no authority. The command (or the Judgment) is for none but Allaah. He has commanded that you Worship none but Him (i.e. his Monotheism), that is the (true) Straight religion, but Most men know not. 41. "O two companions of the prison! As for one of you, He (as a servant) will Pour out wine for his Lord (king or master) to drink; and as for the other, He will be crucified and birds will eat from his head. Thus is the case judged concerning which you both did inquire." 42. and He said to the one whom He knew to be saved: "Mention Me to Your Lord (i.e. Your king, so as to get Me out of the prison)." but ShayTaan (Satan) made Him forget to mention it to his Lord [or Satan made [(Yûsuf (Joseph))] to forget the remembrance of his Lord (Allaah) as to ask for his help, instead of others]. So [Yûsuf (Joseph)] stayed in prison a few (more) years.

[Soorat Yoosuf: 36-42]

There were two men in prison with Prophet Yoosuf ﷺ and they each beheld a dream. They trusted Yoosuf ﷺ and believed him to be from amongst the good people and

therefore felt secure in telling him their dreams. One man saw himself making wine and the other saw himself carrying bread on his head and saw birds eating from it. They asked for Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾ for an interpretation of these dreams. Prophet Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾ told them that he would explain their dreams before the next meal arrived for them to eat. He told them that the interpretation he would provide was from Allaah ﴿عَزَّ وَجَلَّ﴾. By speaking of Allaah ﴿عَزَّ وَجَلَّ﴾, he diverted their conversation towards the subject of da'wah and the worship of Allaah ﴿عَزَّ وَجَلَّ﴾ alone.

We see through this that when a person has imaan, he calls to Islaam no matter what the circumstance. Prophet Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾ exemplifies the fact that the greatest blessing is the shahadah and that thankfulness to Allaah ﴿عَزَّ وَجَلَّ﴾ can be shown by using this blessing and calling others to Islaam. When Allaah ﴿عَزَّ وَجَلَّ﴾ revealed the first aayaat He commanded us to recite in the name of our Lord who created us, thereby showing that the greatest blessing we have is *la ilaha ilallah*. Thankfulness to Allaah ﴿عَزَّ وَجَلَّ﴾ for any blessing that we have been granted will result in Allaah ﴿عَزَّ وَجَلَّ﴾ increasing this blessing for us. Therefore, show your thankfulness by calling others to the path that Allaah ﴿عَزَّ وَجَلَّ﴾ has prescribed.

In calling these men to Islaam, Prophet Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾ speaks to them in a manner that they will understand. He questions them to allow them to begin thinking about the issue at hand asking, is not one God better than the worship of many gods? Prophet Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾ then speaks to them about the fact that their gods were made up and says that their names can be traced back to those who began worshipping them. He then brings the conversation back to the magnificence of Allaah ﴿عَزَّ وَجَلَّ﴾ and His authority.

After speaking to the men about Allaah, Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾ interpreted their dreams. He told one of them, but did not specify which one, that he will be released from prison and will serve wine to the king. He then told the other one that he will be crucified and that birds will eat from his head. Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾ asked the one who would be released from prison to mention his name to the king but the ShayTaan made him forget. Another interpretation of this is that ShayTaan made Prophet Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾ asked a human being for help rather than seeking help from Allaah ﴿عَزَّ وَجَلَّ﴾ alone, therefore Allaah punished him for this, and kept him in prison for several years. Linguistically, both of the previously mentioned interpretations can be valid. The first interpretation is the stronger opinion because asking someone for help is permissible in order to use every means possible. It is not permissible to ask people for assistance with things that only Allaah ﴿عَزَّ وَجَلَّ﴾ is capable of, but it is permissible to ask others for help with worldly things. Some scholars state that Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾ stayed in prison for 7 to 8 years after this incident.

Side note

One of the fitnahs of the ShayTaan is that he causes us to forget. He does this in particular when we are praying. This is why Allaah ﷻ has granted us the mercy of making sujood for forgetfulness- to show the ShayTaan that causing us to forget during prayer will only cause us to make extra sujood to Allaah ﷻ. If you are unsure how many rak'aat you have prayed, base the rest of your prayer on the lesser of the two. If you forget during prayer, do sujood before the salaam. If you forget for a moment and then remember again, do sujood after the salaam. If you find that you often forget things, keep Allaah ﷻ constantly in your mind and you will find that you will not forget as much.

Aayaat 43-49

Allaah ﷻ says:

وَقَالَ لِلَّذِي ظَنَّ أَنَّهُ نَاجٍ مِّنْهُمَا اذْكُرْنِي عِندَ رَبِّكَ فَأَنَسَهُ الشَّيْطَانُ ذِكْرَ رَبِّهِ
 فَلَبِثَ فِي السِّجْنِ بِضْعَ سِنِينَ ﴿٤٣﴾ وَقَالَ الْمَلِكُ إِنِّي أَرَى سَبْعَ بَقَرَاتٍ سِمَانٍ يَأْكُلُهُنَّ
 سَبْعٌ عِجَافٌ وَسَبْعَ سُنبُلَاتٍ خُضْرٍ وَأُخَرَ يَابِسَاتٍ يَا أَيُّهَا الْمَلَأُ أَفْتُونِي فِي رُءْيَايَ إِن كُنْتُمْ
 لِلرُّءْيَا تَعْبُرُونَ ﴿٤٤﴾ قَالُوا أَضْغَتْ أَحْلَمٌ وَمَا نَحْنُ بِتَأْوِيلِ الْأَحْلَمِ بِعَلَمِينَ ﴿٤٥﴾
 وَقَالَ الَّذِي نَجَا مِنْهُمَا وَادَّكَرَ بَعْدَ أُمَّةٍ أَنَا أُنَبِّئُكُمْ بِتَأْوِيلِهِ فَأَرْسِلُونِ ﴿٤٦﴾ يُوسُفُ أَيُّهَا
 الصِّدِّيقُ أَفْتِنَا فِي سَبْعِ بَقَرَاتٍ سِمَانٍ يَأْكُلُهُنَّ سَبْعٌ عِجَافٌ وَسَبْعِ سُنبُلَاتٍ خُضْرٍ
 وَأُخَرَ يَابِسَاتٍ لَّعَلِّي أَرْجِعُ إِلَى النَّاسِ لَعَلَّهُمْ يَعْلَمُونَ ﴿٤٧﴾ قَالَ تَزْرَعُونَ سَبْعَ سِنِينَ دَأْبًا
 فَمَا حَصَدْتُمْ فَذَرُوهُ فِي سُنْبُلِهِ إِلَّا قَلِيلًا مِّمَّا تَأْكُلُونَ ﴿٤٨﴾ ثُمَّ يَأْتِي مِنْ بَعْدِ ذَلِكَ سَبْعٌ
 شِدَادٌ يَأْكُلْنَ مَا قَدَّمْتُمْ لَهُنَّ إِلَّا قَلِيلًا مِّمَّا تَحْصِنُونَ ﴿٤٩﴾ ثُمَّ يَأْتِي مِنْ بَعْدِ ذَلِكَ عَامٌ فِيهِ
 يُغَاثُ النَّاسُ وَفِيهِ يَعْصِرُونَ ﴿٥٠﴾

43. And the king (of Egypt) said: "Verily, I saw (in a dream) seven fat cows, whom seven lean ones were devouring - and of seven green ears of corn and (seven) others dry. O notables! Explain to me my dream, if it be that you can interpret dreams." 44. They said: "Mixed up false dreams and we are not skilled in the interpretation of dreams." 45. Then the man who was released (one of the two who were in prison), now at length remembered and said: "I

will tell you its interpretation, so send me forth." 46. (He said): "O Yûsuf (Joseph), the man of truth! Explain to us (the dream) of seven fat cows whom seven lean ones were devouring, and of seven green ears of corn, and (seven) others dry, that I may return to the people, and that they may know." 47. [(Yûsuf (Joseph))] said: "For seven consecutive years, you shall sow as usual and that (the harvest) which you reap you shall leave in ears, (all) - except a little of it which you may eat. 48. "Then will come after that, seven hard (years), which will devour what You have laid by In advance for them, (all) except a little of that which You have guarded (stored). 49. "Then thereafter will come a year in which people will have abundant rain and in which they will press (wine and oil)."

[Soorat Yoosuf: 43-49]

lean/skinny: عجاف

fat: سمان

gummbles dreams mumble, false dreams: أضغاث أحلام

The king of Egypt is referred to as the "pharaoh"; however this term is only used in the Qur'aan during the time of Musa. During the time of Prophet Yoosuf (عليه السلام), there was a breakage of the Pharaohic leadership because the leaders in Egypt during that time were Asian and ruled for 100 years. They took over the Northern part of Egypt and referred to themselves as kings, not pharaohs, because they were not Egyptian. In Soorat Yoosuf, Allaah (ﷻ) refers to the pharaoh as "king," which provides further proof that the Qur'aan is from Allaah (ﷻ). During this time, Prophet Yoosuf (عليه السلام) was chosen as a leader since a precedent had been set wherein the leaders were not Egyptians.

The king asked for an interpretation of his dream because he knew that they were not ordinary dreams since he had them several times and remembered them vividly. In his dream, he saw seven fat cows that were being eaten by seven lean cows. He also saw seven healthy pieces of corn and seven dried ones. Symbolism in dreams can change therefore one cannot read books that provide interpretations of dreams; something might have a significant meaning in one country while it has a completely different meaning in another country. Those whose advice the king sought did not know the meaning of the dreams and therefore said that they could not be interpreted.

The other prisoner, who had parted Prophet Yoosuf (عليه السلام) seven to eight years earlier in prison, suddenly remembered that Yoosuf (عليه السلام) could interpret dreams. He asked the king for permission to leave and he will interpret his dream. In order to try to take the credit for the

interpretation of the king's dream, the other prisoner visited Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾ and sought his expertise. Rather than being upset that he had not given his message to the king, Prophet Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾ immediately told him the interpretation of the dream and also provided advice based on the meaning of the dream. This shows the immense patience of Prophet Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾. He said that the seven fat cows and healthy pieces of corn represent years of good harvest and the seven lean cows and dried pieces of corn represent years of bad harvest due to drought. He advised that, for the next seven years, the normal routine should be maintained but eat only a little of what is harvested in order to save it for the following seven years. Prophet Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾ also deduced something from the dream- that in the year following the seven years of drought, there would be abundant rain. He knew that after a drought has ended, the year following it must be prosperous. However, this was the prophet's deduction and wasn't mentioned in the king's dream.

Aayaat 50-53

Allaah ﷻ says:

وَقَالَ الْمَلِكُ أَتُؤْتُونِي بِهِ ^ط فَلَمَّا جَاءَهُ الرَّسُولُ قَالَ أَرْجِعْ إِلَىٰ رَبِّكَ فَسْأَلُهُ مَا بَالُ النِّسْوَةِ
الَّتِي قَطَّعْنَ أَيْدِيَهُنَّ إِنَّ رَبِّي بِكَيْدِهِنَّ عَلِيمٌ ﴿٥٠﴾ قَالَ مَا خَطْبُكُنَّ إِذْ رَاودْتُنَّ يُوسُفَ عَنِ
نَفْسِهِ ^ع قُلْنَ حَاشَ لِلَّهِ مَا عَلِمْنَا عَلَيْهِ مِنْ سُوءٍ ^ع قَالَتِ امْرَأَتُ الْعَزِيزِ الْمَن حَصْحَصَ
الْحَقُّ أَنَا رَاودْتُهُ ^ع عَنْ نَفْسِهِ ^ع وَإِنَّهُ لَمِنَ الصَّادِقِينَ ﴿٥١﴾ ذَلِكَ لِيَعْلَمَ أَنِّي لَمْ أَخُنْهُ
بِالْغَيْبِ وَأَنَّ اللَّهَ لَا يَهْدِي كَيْدَ الْخَائِبِينَ ﴿٥٢﴾ وَمَا أُبْرِئُ نَفْسِي ^ع إِنَّ النَّفْسَ لَأَمَّارَةٌ
بِالسُّوءِ إِلَّا مَا رَحِمَ رَبِّي ^ع إِنَّ رَبِّي غَفُورٌ رَحِيمٌ ﴿٥٣﴾

50. And the king said: "Bring Him to me." but when the Messenger came to him, [Yûsuf (Joseph)] said: "Return to Your Lord and ask him, 'What happened to the women who cut their hands? Surely, My Lord (Allaah) is Well-Aware of their plot.'" 51. (The King) said (to the women): "What was your affair when you did seek to seduce Yûsuf (Joseph)?" The women said: "Allaah forbid! No evil know we against him!" The wife of Al-'Azîz said: "Now the Truth is manifest (to all), it was I who sought to seduce him, and He is surely of the truthful." 52. [Then Yûsuf (Joseph) said: "I asked for this enquiry] In order that He (Al-'Azîz) may know that I betrayed Him not in secret. And, Verily! Allaah guides not the plot of the betrayers. 53. "And I free not myself (from the blame). Verily, the (human) self is inclined to evil, except when My Lord bestows His Mercy (upon whom He wills). Verily, My Lord is Oft-Forgiving, Most Merciful."

[Soorat Yoosuf: 50-53]

الأن حصحص الحق: the truth is manifested:

When the King is told the interpretation of his dream, he knows that the prisoner did not interpret the dream on his own so he asked for that person to be brought forth. He sent his guards to Prophet Yoosuf عليه السلام; Prophet Yoosuf عليه السلام told them to return to their king and refused to leave the prison, telling them to ask the king about “the women who cut their hands.” His patience is astonishing! Anyone else would have rushed out of jail after being imprisoned for 10 years but Prophet Yoosuf عليه السلام wanted to clarify his situation so that no one would doubt his innocence. When a person’s reputation is being soiled by others, he should take all proper means to declare his innocence.

The king sought all of the women who cut their hands and heard them testify that they had known no wrong committed by Yoosuf عليه السلام. The wife of Al-‘Azeez now came forth and told the truth that she was the one who had seduced him. Since this occurred in the court of the king, a great number of people heard her confession thereby raising Yoosuf’s عليه السلام reputation once again. The king was amazed at Yoosuf’s عليه السلام patience and the fact that he remained in prison until his name could be cleared.

With regards to aayah 53, there is a difference of opinion amongst the scholars. Some say that this was the statement of the wife of the Al-‘Azeez saying that she has come forward to let her husband know that, although she attempted to seduce Yoosuf عليه السلام, she did not fornicate.

Some say that this was the statement of Yoosuf عليه السلام saying that he did this to inform Al-‘Azeez that he was innocent of all charges. The stronger proof is that this was said by the wife of Al-‘Azeez because the next aayah indicates that Prophet Yoosuf عليه السلام was still in prison since the king called for him.

Side Note

There are three types of souls:

- (a) The one inclined towards good-righteous soul

النفس المطمئنة

- (b) The one inclined towards bad-inclined to pursue evil

النفس الأمارة بالسوء

- (c) The one in the middle, which is when one commits a sin and then feels bad about it afterwards.

النفس اللوامة

Some say that there is no middle soul because the good soul also reproaches itself. To one person a sin may feel like a mountain although it may be something very minor so that soul is blaming itself. The wife of Al-‘Azeez said the soul is inclined toward evil thereby showing that she is blaming her soul. As Muslims, we believe that every soul is pure at its inception; every baby is born with the natural inclination towards good, however, people change their nafs.

Aayaat 54-57

Allaah ﷻ says:

وَقَالَ الْمَلِكُ أَتُؤْنِسُ بِيَّ أَسْتَخْلِصُهُ لِنَفْسِي ۖ فَلَمَّا كَلَّمَهُ قَالَ إِنَّكَ الْيَوْمَ لَدَيْنَا مَكِينٌ
 أَمِينٌ ﴿٥٤﴾ قَالَ أَجْعَلْنِي عَلَى خَزَائِنِ الْأَرْضِ إِنِّي حَفِيظٌ عَلِيمٌ ﴿٥٥﴾ وَكَذَلِكَ مَكَّنَّا
 لِيُوسُفَ فِي الْأَرْضِ يَتَّبِعُوا مِنْهَا حَيْثُ يَشَاءُ ۚ نُصِيبُ بِرَحْمَتِنَا مَنْ نَشَاءُ وَلَا نُضِيعُ أَجْرَ
 الْمُحْسِنِينَ ﴿٥٦﴾ وَلَا جُرْأُولَ الْأُخْرَىٰ خَيْرٌ لِلَّذِينَ ءَامَنُوا وَكَانُوا يَتَّقُونَ ﴿٥٧﴾

54. And the king said: "Bring him to me that I may attach him to my person." Then, when he spoke to him, he said: "Verily, this day, you are with us high in rank and fully trusted." 55. [Yûsuf (Joseph)] said: "Set me over the storehouses of the land; I will indeed guard them with full knowledge" (as a minister of finance in Egypt, in place of al-'aziz who was dead at that time). 56. Thus did we give full authority to Yûsuf (Joseph) in the land, to take possession therein, as when or where he likes. We bestow of Our Mercy on whom We please, and We make not to be lost the reward of Al-Muhsinûn (the good doers - see V.2:112). 57. And Verily, the reward of the Hereafter is better for those who believe and used to fear Allaah and keep their duty to Him (by abstaining from All kinds of sins and evil deeds and by performing All kinds of righteous good deeds).

[Soorat Yoosuf: 54-57]

The king was very impressed by Prophet Yoosuf ﷺ. He called for him and chose him as a personal advisor. At this point the king had not yet seen or spoken to him but he still appointed him. When Prophet Yoosuf ﷺ came, he spoke to him and immediately realized that he was a very trustworthy person. A person who is humble should not ask for leadership unless he knows that he is the only one capable of taking on that role. Prophet Yoosuf ﷺ knew that in all of Egypt, there was no one that could be of assistance during the drought except for him since he was Allaah's messenger and Allaah ﷻ has granted him wisdom and knowledge.

Prophet Yoosuf ﷺ asked to be placed in charge of the maintenance of the products of the harvest- the minister of treasury. He stated that he would guard the harvest because he wanted to

benefit the people even though it was a non-Muslim society. If a Muslim can reach a level through which he can offer something beneficial to society, he should do so regardless of whether it is a Muslim or non-Muslim society. At this point in time and through this position, Prophet Yoosuf عليه السلام was not the king but was more powerful than the king. He was in charge of something that the people needed most- food. Through this position, Allaah سبحانه established him as the most influential and trusted person in Egypt and its surrounding areas.

After the first seven years of abundance passed, seven years of drought prevailed. The drought affected some of the surrounding lands including Palestine where Prophet Yoosuf's عليه السلام family resided. Due to Yoosuf's عليه السلام excellence maintenance of the supplies, there was enough available to allow them to sell to the people of the surrounding lands.

When a person is sincere and does something solely for the sake of Allaah سبحانه without desiring the benefits in this life, he will see the fruits of his actions in this life as well as in the hereafter. However, those who believe and have taqwa تقوى will receive even better in the hereafter. Patience and staying away from that which Allaah سبحانه has forbidden will be rewarded multifold in the next life.

Chapter 8



The Reunion:
Yusuf and the Brothers

Chapter 8: The Reunion: Yoosuf and the Brothers Again

Aayaat 58-62

Allaah ﷻ says:

وَجَاءَ إِخْوَةُ يُوسُفَ فَدَخَلُوا عَلَيْهِ فَعَرَفَهُمْ وَهُمْ لَهُ مُنْكَرُونَ ﴿٥٨﴾ وَلَمَّا جَهَّزَهُمْ بِجَهَّازِهِمْ قَالَ أَتُنُونِي بِأَخٍ لَّكُمْ مِّنْ أَبِيكُمْ أَلاَ تَرَوْنَ أَنِّي أُوْفِي الْكَيْلَ وَأَنَا خَيْرُ الْمُنْزِلِينَ ﴿٥٩﴾ فَإِن لَّمْ تَأْتُونِي بِهِ فَلَا كَيْلَ لَّكُمْ عِندِي وَلَا تَقْرُبُونِ ﴿٦٠﴾ قَالُوا سُرُودٌ عَنْهُ أَبَاهُ وَإِنَّا لَفَاعِلُونَ ﴿٦١﴾ وَقَالَ لِفَتَيْنِهِ أَجْعَلُوا بِضْعَتَهُمْ فِي رِحَالِهِمْ لَعَلَّهُمْ يَعْرِفُونَهَا إِذَا أُنْقَلَبُوا إِلَى أَهْلِهِمْ لَعَلَّهُمْ يَرْجِعُونَ ﴿٦٢﴾

58. And the brothers of Joseph came [seeking food], and they entered upon him; and he recognized them, but he was to them unknown. 59. And when he had furnished them with their supplies, he said, "Bring me a brother of yours from your father. Do not you see that I give full measure and that I am the best of accommodators? 60. But if you do not bring him to me, no measure will there be [hereafter] for you from me, nor will you approach me." 61. They said, "We will attempt to dissuade his father from [keeping] him, and indeed, we will do [it]." 62. And [Joseph] said to his servants, "Put their merchandise into their saddlebags so they might recognize it when they have gone back to their people that perhaps they will [again] return."

[Soorat Yoosuf: 58-62]

Aayah 58

The drought had affected the surrounding areas of Egypt as well and people from all around were coming to Egypt for food. The King of Egypt benefitted greatly from this because when people came for food, they traded their goods for the food. Amongst those who came seeking food were

the brothers of Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾. In ayah 58, Prophet Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾ recognizes his brothers, but they do not recognize him. Since Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾ was much younger than his brothers, he recognized them right away as he would remember their faces, but they did not recognize him because he was very young when he was thrown into the well and he had aged over the years.

The word ‘Munkiroon’ in ayah 58 means to reject; for example, an idea comes to one’s mind but it is pushed aside and rejected. The idea came to the brothers’ minds that the person in authority looked similar to Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾, but given this man’s position they pushed that thought aside because it seemed impossible he would be Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾. They assumed that at the greatest chance he was probably a slave somewhere due to how they left him..

Another important point is that before this time, Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾ did not seek to find his family and brothers despite the position he was in and the ability he had to do so because he was a prophet and as such prophets do not act on their own accord.

Aayaat 59-60

Here, Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾ wants to make sure that everyone is treated justly. He wants to make sure that everyone gets their fair share of the goods. He begins when his brothers come by inquiring about them, their situation, and how many they are in number. They tell him that they have one more brother at home with their father. This is when Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾ notices that his youngest brother, Benjamin, is not with the other brothers who have come to Egypt and he makes a plan to get them to bring him with them next time.

Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾ tells the brothers to bring Benjamin next time because they claim they have another brother. He claims that he wants to make sure they are telling the truth and that they are not spies because Egypt is very prosperous at this time, despite the drought.

Aayah 61

Here the brothers conclude that bringing Benjamin to Egypt is not an easy task. The brothers know that Ya’qoob ﴿يَاقُوبَ﴾ will not easily let Benjamin travel with them to Egypt. He will remember what happened in the past and will guard against being bitten twice by the same snake. He will fear the same for Benjamin that which happened to Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾.

Also, Ya’qoob ﴿يَاقُوبَ﴾ did not send Benjamin with the other brothers the first time because like Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾, Benjamin was very precious to Ya’qoob ﴿يَاقُوبَ﴾. Ya’qoob ﴿يَاقُوبَ﴾ was very over protective of Benjamin, especially after the incident with Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾.

However, the brothers say they will try their best to bring their youngest brother with them next time. The brothers say this because they realize that they *must* bring Benjamin to Egypt, otherwise they will not get ration anymore. Israelite narrations report that at this time their family consisted of 70 members. All of the brothers had grown with families of their own and had to take care of their wives and children. Therefore, they must convince their father to send Benjamin for the survival of their families during this drought.

Aayah 62

This Aayah tells us that Prophet Yoosuf عليه السلام returns his brothers' merchandise with them without the brothers knowing. Prophet Yoosuf عليه السلام tells his people to put the merchandise his brothers brought for trading the ration deep in their sacks of food. They are getting back whatever they paid for the ration.

The scholars say the reason for this is that prophet Ya'qoob عليه السلام and his children must be in a great state of need and hunger due to the drought. Therefore, they are bringing everything they have to trade for ration due to their great need for food. So, if Prophet Yoosuf عليه السلام takes everything, they will not return since they will not have anything to trade with. Yoosuf عليه السلام does this in order to ensure that the brothers will return to Egypt.

Aayaat 63-68

Allaah ﷻ says:

فَلَمَّا رَجَعُوا إِلَىٰ أَبِيهِمْ قَالُوا يَتَّابَانَا مُنِعَ مِنَّا الْكَيْلُ فَأَرْسِلْ مَعَنَا أَخَانًا نَكْتَلْ وَإِنَّا لَهُ لَحَافِظُونَ ﴿٦٣﴾ قَالَ هَلْ ءَامَنُكُمْ عَلَيْهِ إِلَّا كَمَا ءَامَنُتُمْ عَلَىٰ أَخِيهِ مِن قَبْلُ ۖ فَاللَّهُ خَيْرٌ حَافِظًا وَهُوَ أَرْحَمُ الرَّاحِمِينَ ﴿٦٤﴾ وَلَمَّا فَتَحُوا مَتَاعَهُمْ وَجَدُوا بِضْعَتَهُمْ رُدَّتْ إِلَيْهِمْ قَالُوا يَتَّابَانَا مَا نَبْغِي هَذِهِ ۖ بِضْعَتُنَا رُدَّتْ إِلَيْنَا وَنَمِيرُ أَهْلَنَا وَنَحْفَظُ أَخَانًا وَنَزِدَادُ كَيْلٍ بَعِيرٍ ۚ ذَٰلِكَ كَيْلٌ يُسِيرُ ﴿٦٥﴾ قَالَ لَنْ أَرْسِلَهُ مَعَكُمْ حَتَّىٰ تُتَوْتُوا مَوْثِقًا مِّنَ اللَّهِ لَتَأْتُنِي بِهِ ۚ إِلَّا أَنْ تَحَاطَ بِكُمْ فَلَمَّا ءَاتَوْهُ مَوْثِقَهُمْ قَالَ اللَّهُ عَلَىٰ مَا نَقُولُ وَكِيلٌ ﴿٦٦﴾ وَقَالَ يَبْنَىٰ لَا تَدْخُلُوا مِن بَابٍ وَاحِدٍ وَادْخُلُوا مِن أَبْوَابٍ مُّتَفَرِّقَةٍ وَمَا أُغْنِي عَنْكُمْ مِّنَ اللَّهِ مِنْ شَيْءٍ ۚ إِنِ الْحُكْمُ لِلَّهِ عَلَيْهِ تَوَكَّلْتُ وَعَلَيْهِ فَلْيَتَوَكَّلِ الْمُتَوَكِّلُونَ ﴿٦٧﴾ وَلَمَّا دَخَلُوا مِنْ حَيْثُ أَمَرَهُمْ أَبُوهُمْ مَا كَانَ يُغْنِي عَنْهُمْ مِّنَ اللَّهِ مِنْ شَيْءٍ إِلَّا حَاجَةٌ فِي نَفْسٍ يَعْقُوبَ قَضَاهَا ۚ وَإِنَّهُ لَذُو عِلْمٍ لِّمَا عَلَّمْنَاهُ وَلَٰكِنَّ أَكْثَرَ النَّاسِ لَا يَعْلَمُونَ ﴿٦٨﴾

63. "So when they returned to their father, they said, "O our father, [further] measure has been denied to us, so send with us our brother [that] we will be given measure. And indeed, we will be his guardians." 64. He said, "Should I entrust you with him except [under coercion] as I entrusted you with his brother before? But Allaah is the best guardian, and He is the most merciful of the merciful." 65. And when they opened their baggage, they found their merchandise returned to them. They said, "O our father, what [more] could we desire? This is our merchandise returned to us. And we will obtain supplies

for our family and protect our brother and obtain an increase of a camel's load; that is an easy measurement." 66. [Jacob] said, "Never will I send him with you until you give me a promise by Allaah that you will bring him [back] to me, unless you should be surrounded by enemies." And when they had given their promise, he said, "Allaah, over what we say, is Witness." 67. And he said, "O my sons, do not enter from one gate but enter from different gates; and I cannot avail you against [the decree of] Allaah at all. The decision is only for Allaah; upon Him I have relied, and upon Him let those who would rely [indeed] rely." 68. And when they entered from where their father had ordered them, it did not avail them against Allaah at all except [it was] a need within the soul of Jacob, which he satisfied. And indeed, he was a possessor of knowledge because of what We had taught him, but most of the people do not know."

[Soorat Yoosuf: 63-68]

The brothers return to Palestine to convince Ya'qoob ﴿يَا قُوب﴾ to send Benjamin with them.

Aayah 63

As soon as they returned, they went straight to their father and lied saying that they were denied ration because Benjamin was not with them. They lied because they were afraid that their father would not allow their brother to go with them to Egypt for more ration. Ironically, they use the exact same promise they used with Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفُ﴾, by saying, "We will be his guardians".

Aayah 64

Ya'qoob ﴿يَا قُوب﴾ is now reminded of Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفُ﴾ and asks his sons, "Can I entrust him like I trusted you with Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفُ﴾?" He tells them if they will not get ration without taking their brother, then Allaah ﴿وَاللَّهُ﴾ is the best to take care of them and that He ﴿وَاللَّهُ﴾ will not let them starve. He makes it clear that he will not let Benjamin travel with them under any condition. So, for a time the brothers give up and they return to their belongings to put them away. This is when they are surprised to find their money and goods in their food sacks.

Aayah 65

They come back to their father once more to prove just how kind the minister was in Egypt by telling him that their merchandise was returned. They explain that if they bring Benjamin, they will receive another camel loads worth of ration. The returned merchandise is evidence of the

brothers being truthful since they said the minister of Egypt was very kind. After the merchandise was found Ya'qoob ﴿ٱلْعَلِیَّٱة﴾ allowed Benjamin to go with his brothers to Egypt.

Aayah 66

Finally, Ya'qoob ﴿ٱلْعَلِیَّٱة﴾ allows their Benjamin to go with them under the condition they promise by Allaah that they will protect Benjamin to their last breath. Ya'qoob ﴿ٱلْعَلِیَّٱة﴾ places a condition that they will return Benjamin safely home unless they are surrounded by enemies. "Surrounded by the enemy" is a term in the Arabic language meaning destruction because the enemy has surround you and you are left overwhelmed. In other words, he tells them don't come back to me without your brother unless something happens to you and you yourselves cannot come back because that disaster has affected all of you. He wants them to protect Benjamin until their last breath.

Aayaat 67-68

Here, Ya'qoob ﴿ٱلْعَلِیَّٱة﴾ advises his sons to enter from different gates in order to protect themselves from the evil eye. Yoosuf ﴿ٱلْعَلِیَّٱة﴾ has been described to have half the beauty ever created. Likewise, Yoosuf ﴿ٱلْعَلِیَّٱة﴾'s brothers are handsome as well. Therefore, in order to avoid jealousy, Ya'qoob ﴿ٱلْعَلِیَّٱة﴾ advises his sons to enter from different gates of Egypt. He is afraid that the evil eye may affect them because they are beautiful foreign men entering a strange land. It is important to note that this is done as a precaution, because at the end of the day the effect of the evil eye is under the will of Allaah ﴿رَبِّٱللَّه﴾. The best protection one can take is by placing ones trust in Allaah ﴿رَبِّٱللَّه﴾. Ya'qoob ﴿ٱلْعَلِیَّٱة﴾ understands that his sons can take this precaution, but whatever Allaah ﴿رَبِّٱللَّه﴾ wills will indeed happen. Thus, they obey their father and enter from different doors to attract less attention.

Aayaat 69-79

Allaah ﷻ says:

وَلَمَّا دَخَلُوا عَلَى يُوسُفَ ءَاوَىٰ إِلَىٰ أَخَاهُ قَالَ إِنِّي أَنَا أَخُوكَ فَلَا تَبْتَئِسْ بِمَا كَانُوا يَعْمَلُونَ ﴿٦٩﴾ فَلَمَّا جَهَّزَهُم بِجَهَّازِهِمْ جَعَلَ السَّقَايَةَ فِي رَحْلِ أَخِيهِ ثُمَّ أَذَّنَ مُؤَذِّنٌ أَيَّتُهَا الْعِيرُ إِنَّكُمْ لَسَارِقُونَ ﴿٧٠﴾ قَالُوا وَأَقْبِلُوا عَلَيْهِمْ مَاذَا تَفْقَدُونَ ﴿٧١﴾ قَالُوا نَفَقْدُ صَوَاعَ الْمَلِكِ وَلِمَن جَاءَ بِهِ حِمْلُ بَعِيرٍ وَأَنَا بِهِ زَعِيمٌ ﴿٧٢﴾ قَالُوا تَاللَّهِ لَقَدْ عَلِمْتُم مَّا جِئْنَا لِنُفْسِدَ فِي الْأَرْضِ وَمَا كُنَّا سَارِقِينَ ﴿٧٣﴾ قَالُوا فَمَا جزأؤُهُ إِنْ كُنْتُمْ كَاذِبِينَ ﴿٧٤﴾ قَالُوا جزأؤُهُ مَنْ وَجَدَ فِي رَحْلِهِ فَهُوَ جزأؤُهُ ۚ كَذَلِكَ نَجْزِي الظَّالِمِينَ ﴿٧٥﴾ فَبَدَأَ بِأَوْعِيَّتِهِمْ قَبْلَ وِعَاءِ أَخِيهِ ثُمَّ اسْتَخَرَهَا مِنْ وِعَاءِ أَخِيهِ ۚ كَذَلِكَ كِدْنَا لِيُوسُفَ مَا كَانَ لِيَأْخُذَ أَخَاهُ فِي دِينِ الْمَلِكِ إِلَّا أَنْ يَشَاءَ اللَّهُ ۚ نَرْفَعُ دَرَجَاتٍ مَن نَّشَاءُ ۚ وَفَوْقَ كُلِّ ذِي عِلْمٍ عَلِيمٌ ﴿٧٦﴾ ۞ قَالُوا إِنْ يَسْرِقْ فَقَدْ سَرَقَ أَخٌ لَّهُ مِنْ قَبْلُ فَأَسْرَهَا يُوسُفُ فِي نَفْسِهِ وَلَمْ يُبْدِهَا لَهُمْ ۚ قَالَ أَنْتُمْ شَرُّ مَكَانًا ۚ وَاللَّهُ أَعْلَمُ بِمَا تَصِفُونَ ﴿٧٧﴾ قَالُوا يَأَيُّهَا الْعَزِيزُ إِنَّ لَهُ أَبًا شَيْخًا كَبِيرًا فَخُذْ أَحَدَنَا مَكَانَهُ ۚ إِنَّا نَرَاكَ مِنَ الْمُحْسِنِينَ ﴿٧٨﴾ قَالَ مَعَاذَ اللَّهِ أَنْ نَأْخُذَ إِلَّا مَنْ وَجَدْنَا مَتَاعَنَا عِنْدَهُ ۚ إِنَّا إِذَا لَظَلِمُونَ ﴿٧٩﴾

69. "And when they entered upon Joseph, he took his brother to himself; he said, "Indeed, I am your brother, so do not despair over what they used to do [to me]." 70. So when he had furnished them with their supplies, he put the

[gold measuring] bowl into the bag of his brother. Then an announcer called out, "O caravan, indeed you are thieves." 71. They said while approaching them, "What is it you are missing?" 72. They said, "We are missing the measure of the king. And for he who produces it is [the reward of] a camel's load, and I am responsible for it." 73. They said, "By Allaah, you have certainly known that we did not come to cause corruption in the land, and we have not been thieves." 74. The accusers said, "Then what would be its recompense if you should be liars?" 75. [The brothers] said, "Its recompense is that he in whose bag it is found - he [himself] will be its recompense. Thus do we recompense the wrongdoers." 76. So he began [the search] with their bags before the bag of his brother; then he extracted it from the bag of his brother. Thus did We plan for Joseph. He could not have taken his brother within the religion of the king except that Allah willed. We raise in degrees whom We will, but over every possessor of knowledge is one [more] knowing. 77. They said, "If he steals - a brother of his has stolen before." But Joseph kept it within himself and did not reveal it to them. He said, "You are worse in position, and Allah is most knowing of what you describe." 78. They said, "O 'Azeez, indeed he has a father [who is] an old man, so take one of us in place of him. Indeed, we see you as a doer of good." 79. He said, "[I seek] the refuge of Allaah [to prevent] that we take except him with whom we found our possession. Indeed, we would then be unjust."

[Soorat Yoosuf: 69-79]

Aayah 69

When the brothers enter Egypt, Prophet Yoosuf عليه السلام sees his brother and is able to pull him aside. He reveals his true identity and tells him to not grieve. One interpretation of this is to not grieve over the maltreatment of our brothers anymore. Another interpretation is that Yoosuf عليه السلام is informing Benjamin that he will take care of him that he has a plan—so just follow along and listen.

Aayah 70

After giving his brothers ration, Yoosuf عليه السلام places the King's goblet in their belongings. The King's goblet is found to be missing, so the kingdom is in search for it. They assume that it is a foreigner because the people of the palace see it every day and it has not gone missing before. This causes them to call the people of the caravans thieves.

Aayaat 71-72

The brothers inquire about the chaos and learn that the King's goblet has been stolen. This aayah also lets us know that it is permissible to give a reward for something.

Aayah 73

The brothers explain that they are not there to cause mischief and that they all know that because they had been there before.

Aayaat 74-75

The brothers are asked, what should be the recompense for the one who is discovered to be the culprit if he is amongst them. The brothers explain the ruling of their *shari'ah* and say that the culprit will become the slave of the one he stole from. Prophet Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾ knew this was the ruling and knew this plan would allow Benjamin to stay in Egypt. He knew that the law of the King's land would not allow Benjamin to stay close to his brother Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾ so he used the law of the brothers.

Aayah 76

After learning of the ruling, all of the brothers' bags are searched. Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾ started with his other brothers' bags to divert any suspicion. Finally, the goblet is found in the bag of Benjamin. This is the plan Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾ had been carrying out, but it has been inspired to him by Allaah ﴿وَبِإِذْنِهِ﴾ and Prophets do not act on their own accord.

Aayah 77

Benjamin didn't say anything once the goblet was discovered in his possessions. Silence is taken as admittance of guilt so everyone assumed he was guilty. The brothers said if Benjamin has stolen, his brother was also a thief. They are talking about Prophet Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾, but do not realize they are speaking to him this instance. Scholars say they are uttering falsehood by calling Prophet Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾ a thief and this is just their bad side surfacing. Other scholars mention narration from the Israelites that when Prophet Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾ was young, he took an idol from his maternal grandfather. His maternal grandfather was a polytheist so he wanted him to stop worshipping the idol so he took the idol to prevent his grandfather from committing shirk but we have to remember that sometimes others (i.e. his brothers) interpret actions differently.

Secondly, the scholars differ over what Yoosuf ﴿العليه السلام﴾ hid. The first opinion is that he hid his identity. The second opinion is that he kept his next statement, “You are worse in position...” to himself and did not say it openly.

Therefore, as a result of the plan, Benjamin has to stay since they have given the verdict for the crime themselves because they were certain they had not taken the goblet.

Aayah 78

The brothers remember their promise to their father and ask that one of them be taken in place of Benjamin.

Aayah 79

Prophet Yoosuf ﴿العليه السلام﴾ refuses to take anyone in place of Benjamin and says that he cannot take anyone except the one who was found in possession of the goblet. This shows the subtleness of Prophet Yoosuf’s ﴿العليه السلام﴾ speech in that he does not call his brother a thief.

Chapter 9



**The Complication:
Ya'qub and the Sons**

Chapter 9: The Complication: Ya'qoob and the Sons

Aayaat 80-87

Allaah ﷻ says:

فَلَمَّا أَسْتَيْسُوا مِنْهُ خَلَصُوا نَجِيًّا ۖ قَالَ كَبِيرُهُمْ أَلَمْ
تَعْلَمُوا أَنَّ أَبَاكُمْ قَدْ أَخَذَ عَلَيْكُمْ مَوْثِقًا مِنَ اللَّهِ وَمِنْ قَبْلُ مَا فَرَّطْتُمْ فِي يُوسُفَ
فَلَنْ أُبْرَحَ الْأَرْضَ حَتَّى يَأْذَنَ لِي أَبِي أَوْ يَحْكُمَ اللَّهُ لِي ۖ وَهُوَ خَيْرُ الْحَاكِمِينَ ﴿٨٠﴾
أَرْجِعُوا إِلَى آبَائِكُمْ فَقُولُوا يَتَّابَانَا إِنَّ أَبْنَاكَ سَرَقَ وَمَا شَهِدْنَا إِلَّا بِمَا عَلَّمَنَا وَمَا
كُنَّا لِلْغَيْبِ حَافِظِينَ ﴿٨١﴾ وَسَأَلَ الْقَرْيَةَ الَّتِي كُنَّا فِيهَا وَالْعِيرَ الَّتِي أَقْبَلْنَا فِيهَا
وإِنَّا لَصَادِقُونَ ﴿٨٢﴾ قَالَ بَلْ سَوَّلَتْ لَكُمْ أَنْفُسُكُمْ أَمْرًا ۖ فَصَبْرٌ جَمِيلٌ ۖ عَسَى اللَّهُ
أَنْ يَأْتِيَنِي بِهِمْ جَمِيعًا ۚ إِنَّهُ هُوَ الْعَلِيمُ الْحَكِيمُ ﴿٨٣﴾ وَتَوَلَّى عَنْهُمْ وَقَالَ يَأْسَفُ
عَلَى يُوسُفَ وَأَبْيَضَتْ عَيْنَاهُ مِنَ الْحُزْنِ فَهُوَ كَظِيمٌ ﴿٨٤﴾ قَالُوا تَاللَّهِ تَفْتُوا تَذْكُرُ
يُوسُفَ حَتَّى تَكُونَ حَرَضًا أَوْ تَكُونَ مِنَ الْهَالِكِينَ ﴿٨٥﴾ قَالَ إِنَّمَا أَشْكُوا
بَنِي وَحُزْنِي إِلَى اللَّهِ وَأَعْلَمُ مِنَ اللَّهِ مَا لَا تَعْلَمُونَ ﴿٨٦﴾ يَبْنِي أَذْهَبُوا فَتَحَسَّسُوا
مِنْ يُوسُفَ وَأَخِيهِ وَلَا تَأْيِسُوا مِنْ رَوْحِ اللَّهِ إِنَّهُ لَا يَأْيِسُ مِنْ رَوْحِ اللَّهِ إِلَّا الْقَوْمُ
الْكَافِرُونَ ﴿٨٧﴾

80. So, when they despaired of him, they held a conference In private. the eldest among them said: "Know You not that Your father did take an oath from You In Allâh's Name, and before This You did fail In Your duty with Yûsuf (Joseph)? Therefore I will not leave This land until My father permits Me, or Allâh decides My case (by releasing Benjamin) and He is the best of the judges. 81: "Return to Your father and say, 'O Our father! Verily, Your son (Benjamin) has stolen, and we testify not except according to what we know, and we could not know the unseen!'" 82: "And ask (the people of) the town where we have been, and the caravan In which we returned, and indeed we are telling the truth." 83: "He [Ya'qûb (Jacob)] said: "Nay, but Your ownelves have beguiled You into something. so patience is Most fitting (for me). may be Allâh will bring them (back) All to Me. truly He! Only He is All-Knowing, All-Wise." 84: "and He turned away from them and said: "Alas, My grief for Yûsuf (Joseph)!" and He lost his sight because of the sorrow that He was suppressing." 85: "They said: 'By Allâh! You will never cease remembering Yûsuf (Joseph) until You become weak with old age, or until You be of the dead.'" 86: "He said: 'I Only complain of My grief and sorrow to Allâh, and I know from Allâh that which You know not.' 87: "O My sons! Go You and inquire about Yûsuf (Joseph) and his brother, and never give up hope of Allâh's Mercy. certainly no one despairs of Allâh's Mercy, except the people who disbelieve."

[Soorat Yoosuf: 80-87]

Aayah 80

The brothers became hopeless, and in their desolation, they consulted with each other on what to do next.

Allaah ﷻ mentions the eldest son specifically in this aayah because he did something good. If a person does something good or has good character, Allaah ﷻ mentions them to highlight that good characteristic. However, when it's the opposite scenario where a person does something wrong or has a bad character or trait He ﷻ never mentions them by name so as to conceal their identity.

Hence, the eldest reminds his brothers about the promise they had made to their father in the name of Allaah ﷻ. He informs them of his decision to not leave this town, regardless of his family being in Palestine, until his father gives him permission, or, Allaah ﷻ judges the matter. Some scholars have mentioned that the eldest son had originally given the idea to put

Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾ in the well instead of killing him. They say that after Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾ and Benjamin, he was Prophet Ya'qoob's ﴿يَاقُوبَ﴾ favorite son.

Aayah 81

They decided to tell their father that they weren't aware of the events that unfolded upon their advent into Egypt; that among his youngest son's possessions, a stolen goblet was found, and he remained silent, which proved the crime.

There are two interpretations of the last part of the aayah, "we could not know the unseen." One of them could mean that they couldn't have predicted what happened to the youngest son. The other could mean that they couldn't have protected him from stealing, since they weren't with him the entire time.

Aayah 82

They tell their father to either ask the people of the town to verify what happened, but since he was too old to travel, to ask those who traveled with them. Surely, they would attest to the truth of their story.

Aayah 83

However, Prophet Ya'qoob ﴿يَاقُوبَ﴾ responded by saying that it was just another invented story, and he added the beautiful phrase, that patience was most fitting for him in the calamity that resulted in him losing 2 more of his sons.

The phrase "*Sabrun Jameel*," - beautiful patience, means to not complain to anyone but Allaah ﴿اللَّهُ﴾. It is to trust in Allaah ﴿اللَّهُ﴾ and be patient in the situation or hardship. Furthermore, one just mentions their needs to Allaah ﴿اللَّهُ﴾, turns to Allaah ﴿اللَّهُ﴾, thus strengthening their faith and connection with Allaah ﴿اللَّهُ﴾.

This aayah also goes to show that after the disappearance of Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾ for over 20 years, his father still had hope in Allaah ﴿اللَّهُ﴾, due to the dream that Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾ had, that his son was alive. Most importantly, his patience never left him during those long years.

Aayah 84

He turned around and then he remembered Yoosuf ﴿الْيُوسُفَ﴾. This turning around is important because beautiful patience means you don't turn to others. That's why he turned away from them and turned to Allaah ﴿سُبْحَانَكَ﴾. He cried until he became blind.

Aayah 85

The sons hear their father mention Yoosuf ﴿الْيُوسُفَ﴾, and express their agitation by saying that their father was still remembering his long lost son. They continue by saying that he would become senile or die in that state.

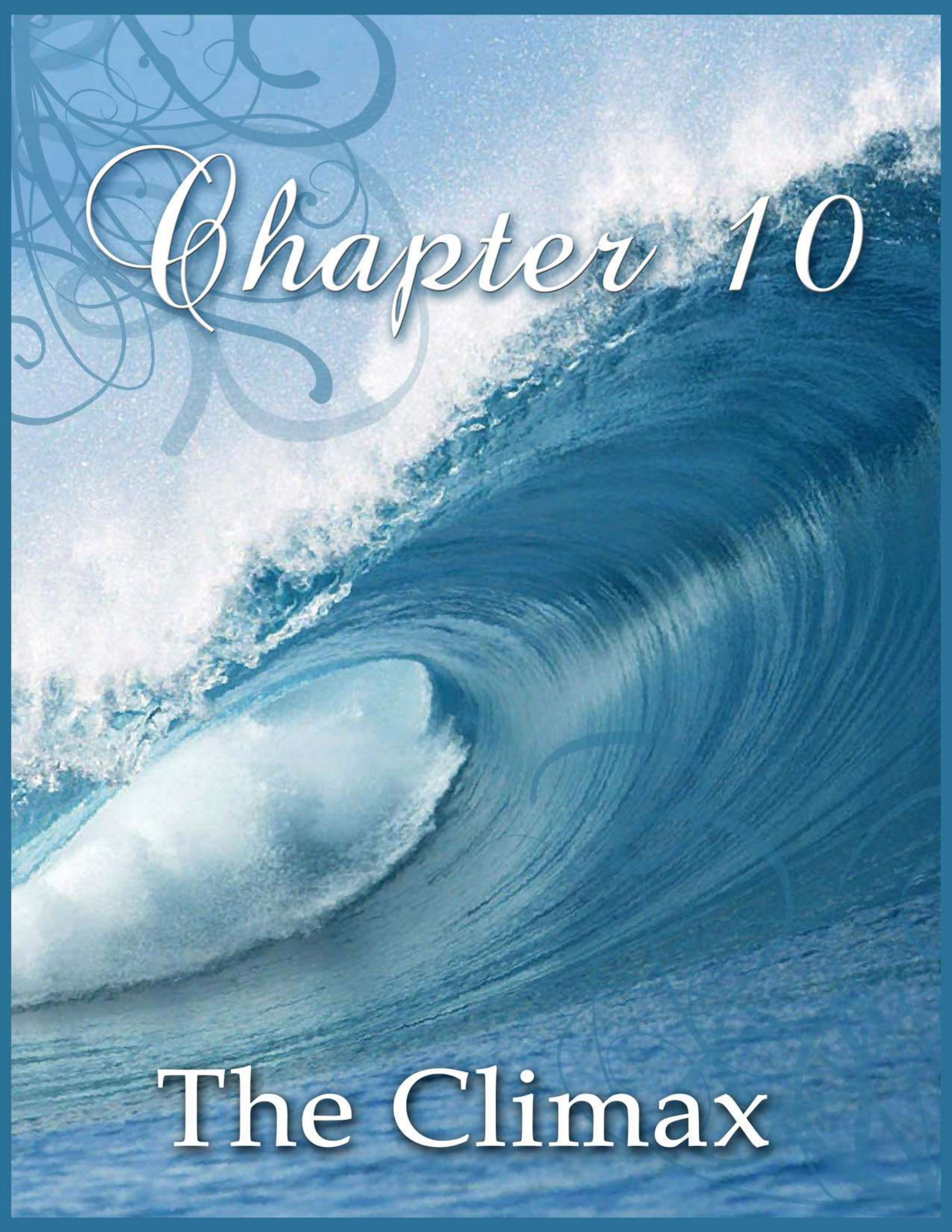
Aayah 86

Ya'qoob ﴿الْيَاكُوبَ﴾ replied by saying that he wasn't mentioning his anguish to them, but only to Allaah ﴿سُبْحَانَكَ﴾, and that he is not looking for their sympathy, but only hoping for Allaah ﴿سُبْحَانَكَ﴾'s Mercy.

Some might say that his crying affected the state of him being patient. However, regardless of his crying, because he turned to Allaah ﴿سُبْحَانَكَ﴾, it strengthened his relationship with Him. Therefore, Ya'qoob's ﴿الْيَاكُوبَ﴾ crying did not affect his patience negatively.

Aayah 87

Ya'qoob ﴿الْيَاكُوبَ﴾ told his sons to leave and look for Yoosuf ﴿الْيُوسُفَ﴾ and his brother, and to not give up hope in Allaah ﴿سُبْحَانَكَ﴾'s Mercy. No one gives up hope of Allaah ﴿سُبْحَانَكَ﴾'s Mercy unless they are disbelievers. As believers it is essential for us to know that no matter how great the sin is the Mercy of Allaah ﴿سُبْحَانَكَ﴾ is greater. When hope is lost in His Mercy it is as if the person is saying that his sin overcame Allaah ﴿سُبْحَانَكَ﴾'s Mercy, saying that is a sign of disbelief.



Chapter 10

The Climax

Chapter 10: The Climax

Aayaat 88-93

Allaah ﷻ says:

فَلَمَّا دَخَلُوا عَلَيْهِ قَالُوا يَا أَيُّهَا الْعَزِيزُ مَسَّنَا وَأَهْلَنَا الضُّرُّ وَجِئْنَا بِبِضْعَةٍ مُزَجَّجَةٍ فَأَوْفِ

لَنَا الْكَيْلَ وَتَصَدَّقْ عَلَيْنَا إِنَّ اللَّهَ تَجَزَّى الْمُتَصَدِّقِينَ ﴿٨٨﴾ قَالَ هَلْ عَلِمْتُمْ مَا

فَعَلْتُمْ يَوْسُفَ وَأَخِيهِ إِذْ أَنْتُمْ جَاهِلُونَ ﴿٨٩﴾ قَالُوا أَأَنْتَ يَاسُفُ قَالَ أَنَا

يَوْسُفُ وَهَذَا أَخِي قَدْ مَنَّ اللَّهُ عَلَيْنَا إِنَّهُ مَنْ يَتَّقِ وَيَصْبِرْ فَإِنَّ اللَّهَ لَا يُضِيعُ

أَجْرَ الْمُحْسِنِينَ ﴿٩٠﴾ قَالُوا تَاللَّهِ لَقَدْ ءَاثَرَكَ اللَّهُ عَلَيْنَا وَإِنْ كُنَّا لَخَطِئِينَ

﴿٩١﴾ قَالَ لَا تَثْرِيبَ عَلَيْكُمُ الْيَوْمَ يَغْفِرُ اللَّهُ لَكُمْ وَهُوَ أَرْحَمُ الرَّاحِمِينَ ﴿٩٢﴾

أَذْهَبُوا بِقَمِيصِي هَذَا فَالْقُوهُ عَلَى وَجْهِ أَبِي يَأْتِ بَصِيرًا وَأْتُونِي بِأَهْلِكُمْ

أَجْمَعِينَ ﴿٩٣﴾

88: "Then, when they entered unto Him [Yûsuf (Joseph)], they said: 'O ruler of the land! a hard time has hit us and Our family, and we have brought but poor capital, so pay us full measure and be charitable to us. Truly, Allâh does reward the charitable.'" 89: "He said: 'Do You know what You did with Yûsuf (Joseph) and his brother, when You were ignorant?'" 90: "They said: 'Are You indeed Yûsuf (Joseph)?' He said: 'I am Yûsuf (Joseph), and This is My brother (Benjamin). Allâh has indeed been Gracious to us. Verily, He who fears Allâh with obedience to Him (by abstaining from sins and evil deeds, and by

performing righteous good deeds), and is patient, Then surely, Allâh makes not the reward of the Muhsinûn (good-doers - see V.2:112) to be lost." 91: "They said: 'By Allâh! indeed Allâh has preferred You above us, and we certainly have been sinners.'" 92: "He said: 'No reproach on You This day, may Allâh forgive you, and He is the Most Merciful of those who show mercy!'" 93: "Go with This shirt of mine, and cast it over the face of My father, He will become clear-sighted, and bring to Me All Your family."

[Soorat Yoosuf: 88-93]

Aayah 88

This aayah shows that as time passed, the famine increased. The brothers came back to Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾ for the third time, yet not knowing it was their brother Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾. They came back with what little they had left, to trade for food. They wanted to trade their few belongings and hopefully get extra from Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾ as charity, and added that Allaah ﴿وَجَّالَهُ﴾ rewards those who are charitable. Following this aayah, Allaah ﴿وَجَّالَهُ﴾ will have finally given Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾ permission to reveal the situation to his brothers.

Aayah 89

Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾ reminds them of what they did to him and his brother, Benjamin back when they were younger. Nobody knows except for Allaah ﴿وَجَّالَهُ﴾, them, and Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾ what had happened. So when Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾ mentions the situation, they recognize him.

Aayah 90

They were baffled when they learned they were talking to Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾, and so they confirmed it again by asking him if he was indeed Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾. In Yoosuf's ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾ reply is a lesson for us; he does not mention what his brothers did to him in the past out of his manners. Instead, he reminds them of Allaah ﴿وَجَّالَهُ﴾ first, that Allaah ﴿وَجَّالَهُ﴾ favored them. Additionally, that whoever is conscious of his Lord, that person's deeds won't go to waste.

Aayah 91

In this aayah, they admitted their wrong and the mistakes they did to Yoosuf (عليه السلام) in the past.

Aayah 92

Again, Yoosuf's (عليه السلام) beautiful demeanor shows through. Regardless of the wrongdoing that had taken place against him, he showed nothing but kindness, and regard for their feelings; he didn't want them to feel uncomfortable. Hence, instead of saying, "you aren't to blame," he says, "there's no blame on you today." He assures them of Allaah (ﷻ)'s Mercy and Forgiveness. He is certain that Allaah (ﷻ) would forgive them because there are two types of sins. The first type is a sin between a person and Allaah (ﷻ), and the second type is a sin between a person and another person. For the latter, forgiveness has to be asked of that person, which is why it's hard to backbite someone and then ask of their forgiveness. This is also why sometimes backbiting is worse than fornication because with the latter, you can repent and ask for forgiveness of Allaah (ﷻ) but in the former, you need to ask permission of the person you backbit first. Hence, because this sin is between Prophet Yoosuf (عليه السلام) and his brothers, and he had forgiven them, he was sure that Allaah (ﷻ) would as well.

This particular aayah was revealed during a difficult and trying time for the Muslims. At Fath Makkah (conquering of Makkah), Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ) had a few options; he could either execute all men, enslave them, or hold them for ransom. The Quraysh were standing nervously, for they weren't sure of their future. They had tried multiple times to assassinate him (ﷺ); he (ﷺ) escaped in the darkness of the night while they were surrounding his (ﷺ) home.

Prophet Muhammad (ﷺ) asked them what they thought he would do to them, and what they thought he should do. They replied saying that he was their relative, and the "son of a noble amongst us and from us." He told them he would do what Prophet Yoosuf (عليه السلام) did with his brothers; he forgave them by saying, "there is no blame upon you today."

Hadeeth:

معشر قريش ، ما ترون أني فاعل بكم ؟ قالوا : خيرا ، أخ كريم وابن أخ كريم ! ! قال : فإني أقول لكم ما قال يوسف لإخوته . : لا تثريب عليكم اليوم ، اذهبوا فأنتم الطلقاء .

"O you people of Quraysh! What do you think of the treatment that I am about to accord to you?" They replied: "O noble brother and son of noble brother! We expect nothing but goodness from you." Upon this he said: "I speak to you in the same

words as Yoosuf (the Prophet Joseph) spoke unto his brothers: He said: "No reproach on you this day," [Surah Yousuf 12:92] go your way, for you are freed ones."

[Fiqh As-Seerah & The Sealed Nectar]

Next time someone harms you, think of Prophet Yoosuf (عليه السلام) and how he forgave those who had harmed him extensively. Keep him mind that most people aren't harmed as he was harmed by his brothers. He was separated from his father for more than twenty years, yet, he forgave. We have to hold back our anger, forgive, and not hold grudges again anyone. The people that enter paradise are those that have healthy, pure, clean hearts. If you can purify your heart in this life, then you will enter Jannah. Neither your children, nor your wealth will avail you, except for those who come toward Allaah (سبحانه) with a clean heart. Think of paradise and realize that nothing is worth keeping you away from paradise.

Allaah (سبحانه) says in Soorah Aali 'Imraan,

وَسَارِعُوا إِلَىٰ مَغْفِرَةٍ مِّن رَّبِّكُمْ وَجَنَّةٍ عَرْضُهَا السَّمَوَاتُ وَالْأَرْضُ أُعِدَّتْ لِلْمُتَّقِينَ



133: "And march forth in the way (which leads to) forgiveness from your Lord, and for Paradise as wide as are the heavens and the earth, prepared for *Al-Muttaqun* (the pious)"

[Soorat Aali 'Imraan: 133]

Who are the muttaqeen? They are those who:

- Spend in times of hardship and in times of ease
- Hold back their anger
- They forgive and don't hold grudges
- Excel in doing good

Hadeeth:

عَنِ أَنَسِ بْنِ مَالِكٍ قَالَ: كُنَّا جُلُوسًا مَعَ رَسُولِ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ فَقَالَ يَطْلُعُ عَلَيْكُمُ الْآنَ رَجُلٌ مِنْ أَهْلِ الْجَنَّةِ فَطَلَعَ رَجُلٌ مِنَ الْأَنْصَارِ تَنْطِفُ لِحْيَتُهُ مِنْ وَضُوئِهِ قَدْ تَعَلَّقَ نَعْلَيْهِ فِي يَدِهِ الشِّمَالِ فَلَمَّا كَانَ الْعَدُو قَالَ النَّبِيُّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ مِثْلَ ذَلِكَ فَطَلَعَ ذَلِكَ الرَّجُلُ مِثْلَ الْمَرَّةِ الْأُولَى فَلَمَّا كَانَ الْيَوْمُ الثَّالِثُ قَالَ النَّبِيُّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ مِثْلَ مَقَالِهِ أَيْضًا فَطَلَعَ ذَلِكَ الرَّجُلُ عَلَى مِثْلِ حَالِهِ الْأُولَى فَلَمَّا قَامَ النَّبِيُّ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ تَبِعَهُ عَبْدُ اللَّهِ بْنُ عَمْرِو بْنِ الْعَاصِ فَقَالَ إِنِّي لَأَحِثُّ أَبِي فَأَقْسَمْتُ أَنْ لَا أَدْخُلَ عَلَيْهِ ثَلَاثًا فَإِنْ رَأَيْتُ أَنْ تُؤْوِيَنِي إِلَيْكَ حَتَّى تَمْضِيَ فَعَلْتُ قَالَ نَعَمْ قَالَ أَنَسٌ وَكَانَ عَبْدُ اللَّهِ يُحَدِّثُ أَنَّهُ بَاتَ مَعَهُ تِلْكَ اللَّيَالِي الثَّلَاثَ فَلَمْ يَرَهُ يَقُومُ مِنَ اللَّيْلِ شَيْئًا غَيْرَ أَنَّهُ إِذَا تَعَارَّ وَتَقَلَّبَ عَلَى فِرَاشِهِ ذَكَرَ اللَّهَ عَزَّ وَجَلَّ وَكَبَّرَ حَتَّى يَقُومَ لِصَلَاةِ الْفَجْرِ قَالَ عَبْدُ اللَّهِ غَيْرَ أَنِّي لَمْ أَسْمَعُهُ يَقُولُ إِلَّا خَيْرًا فَلَمَّا مَضَتْ الثَّلَاثُ لَيَالٍ وَكِدْتُ أَنْ أَحْتَقِرَ عَمَلَهُ قُلْتُ يَا عَبْدَ اللَّهِ إِنِّي لَمْ يَكُنْ بَيْنِي وَبَيْنَ أَبِي غَضَبٌ وَلَا هَجْرٌ ثُمَّ وَلَكِنْ سَمِعْتُ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ يَقُولُ لَكَ ثَلَاثَ مَرَارٍ يَطْلُعُ عَلَيْكُمُ الْآنَ رَجُلٌ مِنْ أَهْلِ الْجَنَّةِ فَطَلَعْتَ أَنْتَ الثَّلَاثَ مَرَارٍ فَأَرَدْتُ أَنْ آوِيَ إِلَيْكَ لِأَنْظُرَ مَا عَمَلُكَ فَأَقْتَدِي بِهِ فَلَمْ أَرَكَ تَعْمَلُ كَثِيرَ عَمَلٍ فَمَا الَّذِي بَلَغَ بِكَ مَا قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ فَقَالَ مَا هُوَ إِلَّا مَا رَأَيْتَ قَالَ فَلَمَّا وَلَّيْتُ دَعَانِي فَقَالَ مَا هُوَ إِلَّا مَا رَأَيْتَ غَيْرَ أَنِّي لَا أَجِدُ فِي نَفْسِي لِأَحَدٍ مِنَ الْمُسْلِمِينَ غِشًّا وَلَا أَحْسَدُ أَحَدًا عَلَى خَيْرٍ أَعْطَاهُ اللَّهُ إِيَّاهُ فَقَالَ عَبْدُ اللَّهِ هَذِهِ الَّتِي بَلَغْتَ بِكَ وَهِيَ الَّتِي لَا تُطِيقُ

Anas Ibn Malik رضي الله عنه reported that he and other companions were sitting with the Messenger ﷺ, who said: "A man from the people of Paradise will enter now." And a man from al-Ansar entered, with his beard dripping with water from Wudhu (ablution), and holding his sandals in his left hand. The following day, the Prophet ﷺ said the same thing and the same man entered. On the third day, the Prophet ﷺ again repeated his statement and the same man entered with water dripping and holding his sandals. When the Prophet ﷺ left, Abdullah Ibn Amr Ibn al-As رضي الله عنه followed the man and said: 'I quarreled with my father and I swore I would not go to him for three days and night. Would you shelter me for these days?' the man replied: 'Yes.' Anas رضي الله عنه said: 'Abdullah said that he stayed with this man for three nights and he did not see him praying at night, but every time he moved and changed position in bed he would remember Allaah ﷻ saying, 'Allaah hu Akbar' Until Salat-ul-Fajr.' Abdullah said: 'I didn't hear anything from him but good. When the three nights had passed I said: 'O slave of Allaah ﷻ! I really didn't abandon

my father nor was I angry with him. But, I heard the Messenger of Allaah ﷺ speaking of you on three separate occasions, the Prophet ﷺ had said that a man from the people of Paradise would enter, and you were the one to enter on all the three times. So, I wanted to stay with you to see what you do so that I could follow you. But I have not seen you doing much. So what is that you do for Allaah ﷻ's Messenger ﷺ to say what he had said?' The man replied: 'It is nothing more than what you saw.' When it was time to leave, he called me back and said: 'Yes, it is nothing more than what you saw, except that I have no place in myself for ill-intentions or Hasad towards any Muslim and what Allaah ﷻ has given them.' Abdullah said: 'This is what has made you deserving of the praise and this is what we cannot do.'

[Musnad Ahmad]

Aayah 93

After having found out that his father, Ya'qoob ﷺ, became blind from crying, Yoosuf ﷺ sent his shirt with the brothers. They were instructed to cast it over their father's face, so he could see again. Then, he asked them to bring their whole family to him in Egypt.

Prophet Yoosuf's ﷺ shirt was the beginning of the cause of Prophet Ya'qoob's ﷺ blindness. Years ago, Yoosuf's ﷺ shirt was brought to Ya'qoob ﷺ as fake evidence, with the story that a wolf ate him. This news marked the beginning of his sadness. For Yoosuf ﷺ, his shirt was the evidence of his innocence, when the wife of Aziz sought to seduce him. Furthermore, now he took off his shirt himself to mark the beginning of his father's eyes being cured of blindness. This shows that remnants of the Prophets are blessed.

Aayaat 94-101

Allaah ﷻ says:

وَلَمَّا فَصَلَ الْعِيرُ قَالَ أَبُوهُمْ إِنِّي لَأَجِدُ رِيحَ يُوسُفَ لَوْلَا أَنْ تُفَنِّدُونِ ﴿٩٤﴾ قَالُوا تَاللَّهِ إِنَّكَ لَفِي ضَلَالِكَ الْقَدِيمِ ﴿٩٥﴾ فَلَمَّا أَنْ جَاءَ الْبَشِيرُ أَلْقَاهُ عَلَى وَجْهِهِ فَارْتَدَّ بَصِيرًا قَالَ أَلَمْ أَقُلْ لَكُمْ إِنِّي أَعْلَمُ مِنَ اللَّهِ مَا لَا تَعْلَمُونَ ﴿٩٦﴾ قَالُوا يَتَّبِعَانَا سْتَغْفِرَ لَنَا ذُنُوبَنَا إِنَّا كُنَّا خَاطِئِينَ ﴿٩٧﴾ قَالَ سَوْفَ أَسْتَغْفِرُ لَكُمْ رَبِّي إِنَّهُ هُوَ الْغَفُورُ الرَّحِيمُ ﴿٩٨﴾ فَلَمَّا دَخَلُوا عَلَى يُوسُفَ ءَاوَىٰ إِلَيْهِ أَبْوِيهِ وَقَالَ ادْخُلُوا مِصْرَ إِن شَاءَ اللَّهُ ءَامِنِينَ ﴿٩٩﴾ وَرَفَعَ أَبْوِيهِ عَلَى الْعَرْشِ وَخَرُّوا لَهُ سُجَّدًا وَقَالَ يَتَّابِتْ هَذَا تَأْوِيلُ رُءُوسِي مِنْ قَبْلُ قَدْ جَعَلَهَا رَبِّي حَقًّا وَقَدْ أَحْسَنَ بِي إِذْ أَخْرَجَنِي مِنَ السِّجْنِ وَجَاءَ بِكُمْ مِنَ الْبَدْوِ مِنْ بَعْدِ أَنْ نَزَغَ الشَّيْطَانُ بَيْنِي وَبَيْنَ إِخْوَتِي ۚ إِنَّ رَبِّي لَطِيفٌ لِمَا يَشَاءُ ۚ إِنَّهُ هُوَ الْعَلِيمُ الْحَكِيمُ ﴿١٠٠﴾ رَبِّ قَدْ ءَاتَيْتَنِي مِنَ الْمُلْكِ وَعَلَّمْتَنِي مِنْ تَأْوِيلِ الْأَحَادِيثِ ۚ فَاطِرَ السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ أَنْتَ وَلِيِّ فِي الدُّنْيَا وَالْآخِرَةِ تَوَفَّنِي مُسْلِمًا وَأَلْحِقْنِي بِالصَّالِحِينَ ﴿١٠١﴾

94: And what the caravan departed [from Egypt], their father said, "Indeed, I find the smell of Yoosuf [and would say that he was alive] if you did not think me weakened in mind." 95: They said, "By Allaah, indeed you are in your [same] old error."

96: And when the bearer of good tidings arrived, he cast it over his face, and he returned [once again] seeing. He said, "Did I not tell you that I know from Allaah that which you do not know?" 97: They said, "O our father, ask for us forgiveness of our sins; indeed, we have been sinners." 98: He said, "I will ask forgiveness for you from my Lord. Indeed, it is He who is the Forgiving, the Merciful." 99: And when they entered upon Yoosuf, he took his parents to himself and said, "Enter Egypt, Allaah willing, safe [and secure]." 100: And he raised his parents upon the throne, and they bowed to him in prostration. And he said, "O my father, this is the explanation of my vision of before. My Lord has made it reality. And He was certainly good to me when He took me out of prison and brought you [here] from Bedouin life after Satan had induced [estrangement] between me and my brothers. Indeed, my Lord is Subtle in what He wills. Indeed, it is He who is the Knowing, the Wise. 101: "My Lord! You have indeed bestowed on Me of the sovereignty, and taught Me the interpretation of dreams; the (only) Creator of the heavens and the earth! You are My Walî (Protector, helper, Supporter, Guardian, etc.) In This world and In the Hereafter, Cause Me to die as a Muslim (the one submitting to Your Will), and join Me with the righteous."

[Soorat Yoosuf: 94-101]

Aayaat 94-96

When they were bringing the shirt back, Ya'qoob ﴿ٱلْعَلِیَّٱة﴾ could feel it coming towards him already. However, his sons doubted him and thought he was going senile. The son who brought the shirt was the one with the most hatred in his heart towards Yoosuf ﴿ٱلْعَلِیَّٱة﴾. However, he changed the most in the end. When the shirt was cast over Ya'qoob's ﴿ٱلْعَلِیَّٱة﴾ face, his vision returned, and he exclaimed that he had already told his sons in the past that he knew what they didn't. He's referring to his hope of Yoosuf ﴿ٱلْعَلِیَّٱة﴾ being alive. Ya'qoob ﴿ٱلْعَلِیَّٱة﴾ never lost faith in Allaah ﴿ٱللّٰهُ﴾.

Aayaat 97-98

They asked for forgiveness and they also asked their father to ask for forgiveness for them. This shows that it is permissible to ask another person to seek Allaah ﷻ's forgiveness for you. The condition, however, is to ask a living person. He told them he would ask forgiveness for them soon. Ya'qoob ﷺ was waiting for the last part of the night to ask for forgiveness because it's the best time to do so.

Aayaat 99-100

The whole family goes to Yoosuf ﷺ and he himself takes his parents in. He had his parents sit on the throne, and everyone prostrated to him. Yoosuf's ﷺ dream in the beginning of the soorah, as a child, finally materialized now. Yoosuf ﷺ forgave them completely so much so that he attributes their wrongdoing to ShayTaan, and doesn't mention the incident of the well.

Another important point to understand is that prostration is done for two reasons. It's done for 'ibaadah (worship); hence, only for the sake of Allaah ﷻ. It's also done for respect. In the time of Yoosuf ﷺ, prostration to show respect was permissible. However, in the Shari'ah of Prophet Muhammad ﷺ, it's not deemed permissible. As Muslims, we only bow down to Allaah ﷻ. Even with the sole intention of showing respect, prostration is not permissible.

Aayah 101

He was a Prophet yet he was still asking Allaah ﷻ to let him die a Muslim. We learn from this act of Yoosuf ﷺ to mention the blessings of Allaah ﷻ while supplicating to Him for Him ﷻ to increase us in them. This shows that he had true faith, for his was balanced between hope and fear. Being a Muslim is the most precious blessing we have and is one that we should be afraid of losing the most.

Hadeeth:

Ai'shah رضي الله عنها was asked what du'a did you hear from the Prophet ﷺ the most, she said: He ﷺ used to say O Changer of hearts, keep my heart firm upon Your religion.

عن أنس بن مالك : كان رسول الله - صلى الله عليه وسلم - يكثر أن يقول : يا مقلب القلوب ! ثبت قلبي على دينك ، فقلت : يا نبي الله ! آمنا بك وبما جئت به ، فهل تخاف علينا ؟ ! قال : نعم ، إن القلوب بين أصبعين من أصابع الله ، يقلبها كيف يشاء

Anas رضي الله عنه related that the Prophet ﷺ used to regularly say,

“O Changer of hearts! Make our hearts firm in Your faith. He was asked, O Messenger of Allah ﷺ! Do you fear (that we may convert) He said, people's hearts are between two fingers of Allah's ﷻ who changes it whenever He ﷻ likes.”

[Ibn Majah, AI-Hakim, At-Tirmidhi and Ibn Hibban]

Finally, this aayah is the du'aa that Prophet Yoosuf عليه السلام made when his family reunited. It marks the end of his story in this soorah.

Chapter 11



**Implication: Lessons for
the Prophet Muhammad
and the Ummah**

Chapter 11: Implication: Lessons for the Prophet Muhammad and the Ummah

Aayaat 102-111

Allaah ﷻ says:

ذَٰلِكَ مِنْ أَنْبَاءِ الْغَيْبِ نُوحِيهِ إِلَيْكَ وَمَا كُنْتَ لَدَيْهِمْ إِذْ أَجْمَعُوا أَمْرَهُمْ وَهُمْ يَمْكُرُونَ ﴿١٠٢﴾ وَمَا أَكْثَرُ النَّاسِ وَلَوْ حَرَصْتَ بِمُؤْمِنِينَ ﴿١٠٣﴾ وَمَا تَسْأَلُهُمْ عَلَيْهِ مِنْ أَجْرٍ إِنْ هُوَ إِلَّا ذِكْرٌ لِلْعَالَمِينَ ﴿١٠٤﴾ وَكَأَيِّنْ مِنْ آيَةٍ فِي السَّمَوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ يَمُرُّونَ عَلَيْهَا وَهُمْ عَنْهَا مُعْرِضُونَ ﴿١٠٥﴾ وَمَا يُؤْمِنُ أَكْثَرُهُمْ بِاللَّهِ إِلَّا وَهُمْ مُشْرِكُونَ ﴿١٠٦﴾ أَفَأَمِنُوا أَنْ تَأْتِيَهُمْ غَشِيَةٌ مِّنْ عَذَابِ اللَّهِ أَوْ تَأْتِيَهُمُ السَّاعَةُ بَغْتَةً وَهُمْ لَا يَشْعُرُونَ ﴿١٠٧﴾ قُلْ هَذِهِ سَبِيلِي أَدْعُو إِلَى اللَّهِ عَلَىٰ بَصِيرَةٍ أَنَا وَمَنِ اتَّبَعَنِي ۖ وَسُبْحَنَ اللَّهُ وَمَا أَنَا مِنَ الْمُشْرِكِينَ ﴿١٠٨﴾ وَمَا أَرْسَلْنَا مِن قَبْلِكَ إِلَّا رِجَالًا نُّوحِي إِلَيْهِم مِّنْ أَهْلِ الْقُرَىٰ ۚ أَفَلَمْ يَسِيرُوا فِي الْأَرْضِ فَيَنْظُرُوا كَيْفَ كَانَ عَاقِبَةُ الَّذِينَ مِن قَبْلِهِمْ ۚ وَلَدَارُ الْآخِرَةِ خَيْرٌ لِلَّذِينَ اتَّقَوْا ۚ أَفَلَا تَعْقِلُونَ ﴿١٠٩﴾ حَتَّىٰ إِذَا اسْتَيْسَسَ الرُّسُلُ وَظَنُّوا أَنَّهُمْ قَدْ كُذِبُوا جَاءَهُمْ نَصْرُنَا فَنُجِّيَ مَن نَّشَاءُ ۚ وَلَا يُرَدُّ بَأْسُنَا عَنِ الْقَوْمِ

الْمُجْرِمِينَ ﴿١٠٢﴾ لَقَدْ كَانَتْ فِي قَصَصِهِمْ عِبْرَةٌ لِأُولِي الْأَلْبَابِ مَا كَانَ حَدِيثًا
 يُفْتَرَى وَلَكِنْ تَصْدِيقَ الَّذِي بَيْنَ يَدَيْهِ وَتَفْصِيلَ كُلِّ شَيْءٍ وَهُدًى وَرَحْمَةً
 لِّقَوْمٍ يُؤْمِنُونَ ﴿١٠٣﴾

102: This is of the news of the Ghaib (unseen) which we reveal by Inspiration to You (O Muhammad). You were not (present) with them when they arranged their Plan together, and (also, while) they were plotting. 103: and Most of mankind will not believe even if You desire it eagerly. 104: and no reward You (O Muhammad) ask of them (those who deny Your Prophethood) for it, it(the Qur'ân) is no less than a Reminder and an advice unto the 'Alamîn (men and jinns). 105: and How many a sign In the heavens and the earth they pass by, while they are averse therefrom. 106: and Most of them believe not In Allâh except that they attribute partners unto Him [i.e. they are Mushrikûn - polytheists - see Verse 6: 121]. 107: Do they Then feel secure from the coming against them of the covering veil of the torment of Allâh, or of the coming against them of the (Final) Hour, All of a sudden while they perceive not? 108: Say (O Muhammad): "This is My Way; I invite unto Allâh (i.e. to the Oneness of Allâh - Islâmîc Monotheism) with sure knowledge, I and Whosoever follows Me (also must invite others to Allâh i.e to the Oneness of Allâh - Islâmîc Monotheism) with sure knowledge. and glorified and Exalted be Allâh (above All that they associate as partners with Him). and I am not of the Mushrikûn (polytheists, pagans, idolaters and disbelievers In the Oneness of Allâh; those who Worship others along with Allâh or set up rivals or partners to Allâh)." 109: and we sent not before You (as Messengers) any but men, whom we inspired from among the people of townships. have they not travelled through the earth and seen what was the end of those who were before them? and Verily, the home of the Hereafter is the best for those who fear Allâh and obey Him (by abstaining from sins and evil deeds, and by performing righteous good deeds). do You not Then understand? 110: (They were reprieved) until, when the Messengers gave up hope and thought that they were denied (by their people), Then came to them Our help, and

whomsoever we willed were delivered. and Our punishment cannot be warded off from the people who are Mujrimûn (criminals, disobedients to Allâh, sinners, disbelievers, polytheists). 111: Indeed in their stories, there is a lesson for men of understanding. it (the Qur'an) is not a forged statement but a confirmation of the Allaah's existing Books [the Taurât (Torah), the Injeel (Gospel) and other Scriptures of Allaah] and a detailed explanation of everything and a Guide and a Mercy for the people who believe.

[Soorat Yoosuf: 102-111]

Aayah 102

This was revealed when the people of Makkah refused to accept Islaam, and the people of Taif had expelled RasoolAllaah ﷺ. In addition, RasoolAllaah ﷺ wasn't present at the time of Yoosuf ﷺ, but he is relating his story to us because this was a revelation to him from Allaah ﷻ. This is a sign of his Messengership and his Prophethood.

Aayah 103

Allaah ﷻ is saying to Muhammad ﷺ that no matter how hard he tries, most people on Earth will not believe in this message.

Aayah 104-105

Everything around us is a Sign of Allaah ﷻ. These are miracles all around us. Allaah ﷻ is posing a question, how many signs must we pass by and continue to turn away when there are so many of them. We continue to turn away small blessings such as flowers' and green leaves in the summer which turn to brown leaves in the fall which fall and are leafless. When we reflect, these are in reality great Signs of Allaah ﷻ.

Aayah 106

There are even those among Muslims who have attributed certain powers that should only be for Allaah ﷻ to certain people thereby committing shirk.

Aayah 107

How do we even know we will live until tomorrow? Today we hear it in the news but tomorrow we could be part of the news. Why do we feel so secure about our life when we don't even know if we will be here the next day?

Aayah 108

The path of the Prophets and Messengers is calling to Allaah ﷻ. There are those who call to themselves, to their way and not the way of Allaah ﷻ.

A side point is that dreams are just glad tidings; we cannot base rulings on dreams.

Aayah 109

The Messengers and Prophets were not from the country or the desert, but they were from the cities. Now as Allaah ﷻ is speaking to RasoolAllaah ﷺ, He tells him ﷺ the home of the Hereafter is the best.

Aayah 110

Allaah ﷻ rescues whomever He ﷻ pleases.. RasoolAllaah ﷺ is in a state of difficult times and does not know where to go and who to turn to. The people of Makkah are trying to kill him and have already rejected Islaam. Others have also rejected Islaam and RasoolAllaah ﷺ asked them to let him at least take shelter. They replied with saying, if your own tribe has not accepted you why should we. Then Allaah ﷻ opens up a way and there is a light at the end of the tunnel and he meets the Ansaar at Madinah and they are waiting for someone to lead them. In Madinah, five years after revelation there was a battle in which all the leaders were killed. There was so much killing that they were tired of it all and they wanted someone to bring them together and they found the Prophet ﷺ.

Aayah 111

“Their stories” refers to the stories of the Prophets and Messengers. Every part of Soorah Yoosuf ﴿يُوسُفَ﴾ has stories, small and large stories. It moves from scene to scene containing lessons for us to take from.

Allaah ﴿عَزَّ وَجَلَّ﴾ relates the best of stories and this particular one is the crème of the crop.

Beautiful Patience – PPN Family

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رَبَّنَا تَقَبَّلْ مِنَّا إِنَّكَ أَنْتَ السَّمِيعُ الْعَلِيمُ
وآخر دعوانا أن الحمد لله رب العالمين